

ENGLISH FOR OFFICE COORDINATION AND ADMINISTRATIVE SUPPORT

Office & Administration English

Clear arrangements. Reliable
follow-through.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For office assistants, reception staff, executive support teams, and administrators coordinating people, records, supplies, and schedules.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight everyday office situations demand precise English: cross-office scheduling, call messages, meeting actions, document corrections, delivery queries, visitor reception, travel comparisons, and deadline negotiations.

01 Scheduling across calendars and time zones

4

Three o'clock in whose office? | Clarify a missing time reference and read back two equivalent local times before issuing a meeting invitation.

02 Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

13

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities | Route a caller by purpose, capture the reference and preferred reply route, and relay a requested deadline without guaranteeing it.

03 Preparing meetings and confirming action points

22

Two quotes, not permission to buy | Use the final minutes of a meeting to confirm an action owner, deliverable, deadline, and deferred agenda item.

04 Checking document versions and access

31

Correct version, missing permission | Correct an outdated document message and request appropriate viewing access without independently widening the audience.

05 Querying office supplies and delivery differences

40

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment | Present a documented quantity discrepancy and request the missing supply information without inventing a cause or approving payment.

06 Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

49

Two Jordans, one visitor reference | Welcome a visitor, distinguish two possible hosts, and explain the waiting arrangement while preserving the actual access boundary.

07 Clarifying travel options and booking status

58

A higher fare with a conditional refund | Compare two supplied rail quotes, explain the conditional refund amount, and distinguish a comparison from an approved booking.

08 Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

67

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window | Explain a capacity conflict with concrete timings and ask the manager to select a priority or change a deadline.

Communication field notes

3

Answers and explanations

76

Fast-access phrase pages

92

Vocabulary index

94

Sources and publication notes

102

Make the arrangement explicit.

Administrative work connects people who hold different pieces of information. A useful message identifies the relevant person or record, separates a request from a promise, and makes the next action easy to understand.

Name the reference

A first name, clock time, or filename may not identify the intended person, moment, or document. Confirm the distinguishing detail before sending an invitation, directing a visitor, or circulating a correction.

"Do you mean 3:00 in your office, which is noon in the other office on this date?"

Keep requests and commitments distinct

A caller can request a deadline without the recipient agreeing to it. A manager can request an extra task without creating extra time. Preserve the request and ask for the missing confirmation or priority decision.

"Lena requests a callback before 4:00; availability has not been confirmed."

Separate preparation from approval

Obtaining quotations is not buying a printer. Comparing fares is not booking travel. A useful action record names the owner, deliverable, and due date without quietly adding spending authority.

"Sam will obtain two quotes by Thursday; no purchase is approved."

Correct the message without expanding authority

Replace outdated information clearly and identify the current source. An access problem should go to the document owner rather than prompting an unauthorized wider share. Courteous reception likewise preserves the actual visitor arrangements.

"Use approved version 3. I will ask the owner to resolve your viewing access."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All organizations, records, prices, schedules, and policies are fictional. Use actual workplace approval, security, privacy, purchasing, and records procedures. The time equivalence is supplied for the fictional meeting date, not a permanent conversion rule. Travel conditions belong only to the quoted options. This book teaches communication, not financial or legal advice, and does not authorize purchases, access changes, payments, or visitor entry.

Three o'clock in whose office?

A Read the situation

Clarify a missing time reference and read back two equivalent local times before issuing a meeting invitation.

Colleague Maya asks assistant Arun to arrange a 3:00 meeting with another office. For the fictional meeting date, 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office. Both calendars are open at that equivalent time, but the request does not identify whose clock Maya means. Arun must confirm the intended office reference before sending invitations. No meeting duration, location, or recurrence has been specified.

PEOPLE / Maya: Colleague | Arun: Administrative assistant

A SMALL CLARIFICATION PREVENTS A LARGE SCHEDULING ERROR

A free calendar does not remove ambiguity in a spoken request. Ask whose local time is intended without suggesting that the colleague has made a foolish mistake. Once clarified, name both offices and their equivalent times in the readback.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing from the initial request?

- A** Whether both calendars are open at the stated equivalent time
- C** The assistant's name

- B** Whether noon and 3:00 can be equivalent here
- D** Whose local time 3:00 refers to

2. What equivalence is supplied for this date?

- A** Noon in Maya's office equals 3:00 elsewhere
- C** 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office

- B** The difference is permanently fixed for all dates
- D** Both offices show 3:00 simultaneously

3. What should happen before invitations are sent?

- A** Confirm the intended time reference
- C** Invent a meeting duration

- B** Assume the sender always means the recipient's time
- D** Treat an open calendar as acceptance

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

local time

Clock time at the specified location.

IN USE confirm local time

time zone

Region using a defined civil-time reference.

IN USE identify the time zone

time reference

Location or standard that gives a clock time meaning.

IN USE clarify the time reference

equivalent time

Different clock display representing the same moment elsewhere.

IN USE read back the equivalent time

calendar availability

Time shown as open or occupied in a calendar.

IN USE check calendar availability

meeting request

Proposal to arrange a meeting with specified details.

IN USE clarify the meeting request

invitation

Message asking identified people to attend an event.

IN USE send the invitation

organizer

Person responsible for arranging the meeting.

IN USE identify the organizer

attendee

Person invited to or participating in a meeting.

IN USE confirm the attendee list

noon

Twelve o'clock in the middle of the day.

IN USE specify noon

date-specific

Valid for the particular date being discussed.

IN USE use a date-specific conversion

daylight saving time

Seasonal clock adjustment used in some locations; abbreviated DST.

IN USE check daylight saving time

Precision check

The supplied equivalence is 3:00 in Maya's office and noon in the other office on the fictional date. Do not put 3:00 on both local displays or assume the same difference applies on every date.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

Coordinated Universal Time

International time reference commonly abbreviated UTC.

IN USE identify Coordinated Universal Time

offset

Difference between one time reference and another.

IN USE verify the relevant offset

calendar entry

Event recorded in a scheduling system.

IN USE check the calendar entry

time display

Clock representation shown to a particular user.

IN USE compare the time displays

scheduling conflict

Overlap between incompatible calendar commitments.

IN USE resolve a scheduling conflict

free slot

Unoccupied period shown in a calendar.

IN USE identify a free slot

tentative hold

Provisional reservation not yet a final agreement.

IN USE distinguish a tentative hold

acceptance

Response agreeing to the stated invitation.

IN USE confirm acceptance

duration

Length of time an event is intended to last.

IN USE request the meeting duration

recurrence

Pattern under which an event repeats.

IN USE confirm recurrence separately

location field

Part of an invitation identifying where the meeting occurs.

IN USE complete the location field

schedule readback

Restatement of the agreed scheduling details.

IN USE give a schedule readback

Precision check

An open calendar is not proof that an invitation has been accepted. The initial request also supplies no duration, location, or recurrence. Confirm the intended reference first and leave other missing invitation details unresolved until they are provided.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE REFERENCE

"Do you mean 3:00 in your office or the other office?"

KEEP THE QUESTION NEUTRAL

"I want to make sure both offices receive the same meeting time."

SEPARATE AVAILABILITY FROM INTENT

"The calendars are open, but I still need your intended time."

READ BACK THE LOCATION

"You mean 3:00 in your office."

EXPLAIN THE EQUIVALENCE

"On this date, your 3:00 is their noon."

STATE AVAILABILITY

"Both calendars are open at that equivalent time."

AVOID DUPLICATE CLOCK LABELS

"The two offices should not both be labeled 3:00."

READ BACK THE OTHER CLOCK

"That will be noon in the other office."

Do you mean ... or ...?

Offers the two relevant interpretations without choosing for the speaker.

On this date

Prevents a supplied time relationship becoming a permanent rule.

Their noon

Names the second office's local display.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE THE DATE

"This conversion is for the meeting date we are discussing."

DISTINGUISH ACCEPTANCE

"An open slot is not an accepted invitation."

IDENTIFY MISSING DURATION

"How long should the meeting last?"

KEEP RECURRENCE SEPARATE

"We have not agreed a repeating schedule."

AVOID A PERMANENT RULE

"I will not assume the same offset for every date."

HOLD THE SEND

"I will confirm the reference before sending."

IDENTIFY MISSING LOCATION

"We still need the meeting location."

CLOSE THE CLARIFICATION

"I have the intended office time and its equivalent clearly recorded."

Before sending

Places clarification ahead of an externally visible commitment.

Still need

Identifies a remaining detail without undoing what is known.

Should not both

Corrects duplicate local labels for the same meeting instant.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which clarification is best?

- A** An open calendar means the time is obvious
- B** I will send 3:00 to both offices
- C** Does 3:00 refer to your office or the other office?
- D** I assume every office uses your clock

2. Which readback preserves the supplied equivalence?

- A** Both offices at midnight
- B** Your office at 3:00; the other office at noon
- C** Both offices at 3:00 local time
- D** Your office at noon; the other office at 3:00

3. What does calendar availability establish?

- A** Every invitee has accepted
- B** The meeting lasts an hour
- C** Recurrence is weekly
- D** The relevant slot is open, not that the intended time is confirmed

4. Which detail must not be invented?

- A** The missing time reference
- B** The need to clarify before sending
- C** A one-hour meeting duration
- D** The supplied noon equivalent

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Three o'clock in whose office?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

schedule readback / Acceptance / time reference / Recurrence / local time / calendar availability / equivalent time / date-specific / meeting request / invitation

- 01 **Maya:** Could you arrange the meeting with the other office for three? Both calendars looked open when I checked, so it should be fairly straightforward.
- 02 **Arun:** I can help. Before I send anything, could we confirm the ¹ _____? Do you mean three in your office or three in theirs?
- 03 **Maya:** Three in my office. I had not included that in the message because I was looking at my own calendar when I wrote it.
- 04 **Arun:** Thank you. For this date, the ² _____ in the other office is noon. I will read back both locations so the request is clear.
- 05 **Maya:** Yes, three here and noon there. I do not want two separate meetings appearing because someone reads the numbers without noticing the office.
- 06 **Arun:** Agreed. We are describing one meeting through two ³ _____ displays. I will not label both offices three o'clock, because that would change the intended arrangement.
- 07 **Maya:** Both calendars are open at that moment. Does that give you everything you need to send the invitation, or are there other details missing?
- 08 **Arun:** The ⁴ _____ helps, but it does not supply the duration or location. Those details were not in the original request, so I will not invent them.
- 09 **Maya:** Good point. Let us settle the time reference now, and I will give you the remaining details separately before the invitation goes out.
- 10 **Arun:** That works. I will keep the ⁵ _____ clear: three in your office, noon in the other office, for the date under discussion. Other details are still outstanding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Maya:** Should we use the same three-hour difference for future meetings with that office? It would save time if we could simply repeat it.
- 12 **Arun:** I would check the relevant date. This is a ⁶ _____ equivalence, not a permanent rule for every meeting. Local clock arrangements can make assumptions about later dates unreliable.
- 13 **Maya:** Understood. And an open calendar does not mean everyone has already agreed to attend, even if the time is now clear between us.
- 14 **Arun:** Correct. ⁷ _____ is separate from an open slot. We should not describe the meeting as accepted by the other office before the relevant response.
- 15 **Maya:** Please keep that distinction in the message. I would like a clean invitation when the other details are ready, without suggesting they have already agreed.
- 16 **Arun:** I will. The ⁸ _____ will state the intended arrangement, and any response can be recorded separately. For now, we have resolved the ambiguity about whose clock you meant.
- 17 **Maya:** Let me check the wording once more: my office at three, the other office at noon, on this date. Nothing has been sent yet.
- 18 **Arun:** That is the correct ⁹ _____. I will retain it while we obtain the remaining details, rather than filling those fields from habit.
- 19 **Maya:** Thanks. I will send the duration and location next. Please do not turn this into a repeating event without checking with me first.
- 20 **Arun:** Understood. ¹⁰ _____ remains unconfirmed. The time reference is now clear, and I will wait for the remaining invitation details before sending.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. time reference | 2. equivalent time | 3. local time | 4. calendar availability | 5. meeting request | 6. date-specific | 7. Acceptance | 8. invitation | 9. schedule readback | 10. Recurrence

Read back one meeting in two local times

F Say it

Complete the scheduling clarification without adding a duration or treating availability as acceptance.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

time / sending / open / noon

Assistant: "Whose local ¹ _____ do you mean?"

Colleague: "Three in my office equals ² _____ at the other office."

Assistant: "Both calendars are ³ _____ at that time."

Colleague: "Confirm the remaining details before ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. time | 2. noon | 3. open | 4. sending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

A Read the situation

Route a caller by purpose, capture the reference and preferred reply route, and relay a requested deadline without guaranteeing it.

Caller Lena Park needs the facilities team about delivery D18, not the finance team about an invoice. Facilities extension is 214. Lena requests a callback before 4:00, but team availability is unknown. Assistant Dev must confirm the delivery reference and preferred contact route, read back the message, and preserve the requested deadline as a request. The conversation supplies no payment problem or confirmed callback commitment.

PEOPLE / Lena: Caller | Dev: Office assistant

ROUTE BY THE PURPOSE, NOT BY THE FIRST FAMILIAR WORD

A delivery reference can sound like an invoice reference over the phone. Confirm the reason for the call before selecting a team. Taking a message is useful work, but it does not give the assistant control over the recipient's availability.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which team does Lena need?

A Facilities

C Payroll

B Finance

D An unidentified invoice department

2. What is the facilities extension?

A 241

C D18

B 412

D 214

3. How should before 4:00 be recorded?

A A guaranteed response time

C A delivery time already agreed

B A confirmed payment deadline

D A requested callback deadline

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

call routing

Directing a telephone inquiry to the appropriate recipient.

IN USE confirm call routing

facilities team

Staff coordinating the relevant building or workplace services.

IN USE contact the facilities team

finance team

Staff handling the relevant financial records and processes.

IN USE distinguish the finance team

extension

Internal telephone number used within an organization.

IN USE confirm the extension

delivery reference

Identifier attached to a particular delivery.

IN USE capture the delivery reference

caller identity

Name and relevant identifying details of the person calling.

IN USE verify caller identity

purpose of call

Reason the caller needs contact.

IN USE clarify the purpose of call

message slip

Written record of a call for another person.

IN USE complete the message slip

callback request

Request for someone to return a telephone call.

IN USE relay a callback request

requested deadline

Time by which the caller would like a response.

IN USE preserve the requested deadline

preferred contact route

Communication method selected by the caller.

IN USE confirm the preferred contact route

contact details

Information needed to reach the intended person.

IN USE verify contact details

Precision check

The reference is delivery D18, and the team is facilities at extension 214. Do not turn the call into an invoice query for finance. A good message retains the name, purpose, reference, contact route, and requested deadline.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

transfer

Connection of an existing call to another line.

IN USE distinguish a transfer from a callback

voicemail

Recorded message left when a recipient is unavailable.

IN USE identify the voicemail option

recipient availability

Whether the intended person or team can respond.

IN USE check recipient availability

message readback

Spoken repetition of a message to confirm its accuracy.

IN USE give a message readback

reference correction

Amendment of a misheard identifier.

IN USE record a reference correction

department

Organizational team with a defined function.

IN USE identify the correct department

misdirected call

Call sent to a recipient who does not handle its purpose.

IN USE prevent a misdirected call

response commitment

Agreed promise to reply at a specified time or stage.

IN USE distinguish a response commitment

call log

Record of telephone contacts and their relevant details.

IN USE update the call log

recipient confirmation

Verification that the intended recipient has received or accepted the message.

IN USE obtain recipient confirmation

urgency

Stated need for prompt attention.

IN USE explain the urgency

handoff note

Message passed to another person for follow-up.

IN USE prepare an accurate handoff note

Precision check

Before 4:00 is Lena's requested response deadline, not a confirmed team commitment. Confirm the preferred route and relevant contact details without inventing a telephone number. A message being taken does not establish that the recipient can meet the request.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE PURPOSE

"Is this about the delivery or an invoice?"

ASK FOR THE REFERENCE

"Could you confirm the delivery reference?"

NAME THE EXTENSION

"Facilities is on extension 214."

ASK FOR THE ROUTE

"How would you prefer the team to contact you?"

IDENTIFY THE TEAM

"You need facilities rather than finance."

READ BACK THE IDENTIFIER

"That is D18, D followed by eighteen."

CONFIRM THE CALLER

"I have your name as Lena Park."

VERIFY THE DETAILS

"May I check the contact details for that route?"

Rather than

Corrects the department without changing the caller's purpose.

D followed by eighteen

Makes a short reference easier to distinguish over the phone.

Would prefer

Elicits the caller's chosen communication route.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CAPTURE THE TIMING

"You are requesting a callback before 4:00."

AVOID AN INVENTED PROMISE

"I can relay the request, but I cannot guarantee that time."

KEEP THE PURPOSE INTACT

"This concerns delivery D18, not an invoice."

INVITE A CORRECTION

"Is any part of that message inaccurate?"

STATE THE LIMIT

"I cannot confirm the team's availability."

SEPARATE TRANSFER AND CALLBACK

"Taking a message is not the same as connecting the call."

READ BACK THE WHOLE MESSAGE

"Lena Park requests facilities to call about D18 before 4:00."

CLOSE HONESTLY

"I will pass on the requested deadline with the contact route."

Requesting

Marks the deadline as the caller's wish, not an accepted promise.

Cannot guarantee

Limits the assistant's commitment while preserving a useful action.

Any part ... inaccurate?

Invites a specific correction to the completed readback.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which message is accurate?

- A** Finance guarantees payment of invoice D18 at 4:00
- B** Facilities has already returned the call
- C** Lena has approved a new delivery charge
- D** Lena Park requests facilities about delivery D18, callback before 4:00

2. Which response overpromises?

- A** Please confirm your preferred contact route
- B** They will definitely call before four
- C** I will relay your requested deadline
- D** Their availability is not confirmed

3. What should Dev ask before closing?

- A** For an invented extension
- B** The preferred contact route and relevant details
- C** Which invoice Lena wants to pay
- D** Whether finance should approve a delivery charge

4. Which number should Dev associate with facilities?

- A** Delivery 214
- B** Invoice 412
- C** Extension 214
- D** Extension 241

Answers and explanations: page 78.

Delivery D18 belongs with facilities

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

response commitment / delivery reference / message readback / extension / handoff note / preferred contact route / callback request / requested deadline / caller identity / purpose of call

- 01 **Lena:** Hello, this is Lena Park. I need to speak with someone about D18. I was sent toward finance, but I do not think that is right.
- 02 **Dev:** Let me check the ¹ _____ first. Are you calling about a delivery or an invoice? I want to make sure the message reaches the right team.
- 03 **Lena:** It is a delivery, D18. I need facilities, not finance. I am not calling about an invoice or asking someone to process a payment.
- 04 **Dev:** Thank you. I have the ² _____ as D18, D followed by eighteen. Facilities is the team you need, and their extension is 214.
- 05 **Lena:** That is correct. I would like them to call me back before four, if possible. I need to speak with the team about that delivery.
- 06 **Dev:** I will record a ³ _____ before four. I cannot confirm their availability, so I should not promise that they can meet the requested time.
- 07 **Lena:** I understand. Please make the timing clear in the message, though. I do not want it reduced to call whenever convenient.
- 08 **Dev:** Certainly. The ⁴ _____ will stay in the message as before four. How would you prefer the team to contact you when they respond?
- 09 **Lena:** A telephone call, please, using the contact number I confirm with you. I would rather discuss the delivery directly than exchange several emails.
- 10 **Dev:** I will note the ⁵ _____ as telephone and verify the relevant details with you. I will not substitute email just because it is easier to forward.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Lena:** Good. Could you also keep my full name with the message? Someone else in our office has called about a different delivery this week.
- 12 **Dev:** Yes. The ⁶ _____ is Lena Park. I will keep your name, delivery D18, and the contact details together so the handoff is not ambiguous.
- 13 **Lena:** And the extension was two-one-four? I wrote two-four-one at first, which may explain why I was getting confused about where to call.
- 14 **Dev:** It is ⁷ _____ 214, two-one-four. The delivery identifier remains D18. I will keep those two kinds of reference separate in the note.
- 15 **Lena:** Thanks. Please read the message back before we finish. I would like to check the team, the reference, and the time together.
- 16 **Dev:** Here is the ⁸ _____: Lena Park requests a telephone callback from facilities about delivery D18 before four. The contact details are to be verified, and team availability is not confirmed.
- 17 **Lena:** That captures it. Please do not say finance has to approve anything, because that would send the conversation in a different direction again.
- 18 **Dev:** Agreed. The ⁹ _____ will contain no payment or finance-approval request. Its purpose is to get the delivery question to the appropriate facilities colleagues.
- 19 **Lena:** Then I understand what you can do: pass on the message and its requested deadline, without promising a response you cannot control.
- 20 **Dev:** Exactly. A ¹⁰ _____ has not yet been established. I will relay the accurate request and keep the distinction clear.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. purpose of call | 2. delivery reference | 3. callback request | 4. requested deadline | 5. preferred contact route | 6. caller identity | 7. extension | 8. message readback | 9. handoff note | 10. response commitment

Pass on the caller's actual request

F Say it

Complete the message summary. Keep the department, reference, extension, and deadline status accurate.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

D18 / 214 / deadline / facilities

Assistant: "Lena needs the ¹ _____ team."

Caller: "The delivery reference is ² _____."

Assistant: "The team extension is ³ _____."

Caller: "Before 4:00 is my requested ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. facilities | 2. D18 | 3. 214 | 4. deadline

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two quotes, not permission to buy

A Read the situation

03

Use the final minutes of a meeting to confirm an action owner, deliverable, deadline, and deferred agenda item.

Ten minutes remain in an office meeting. The two outstanding agenda items are printer replacement and visitor signage. Chair Farah prioritizes the printer decision. Assistant Sam can obtain two quotations by Thursday, but nobody has approved a purchase. Sam must ask Farah to confirm that action and defer signage to the next meeting. The record must not turn quote gathering into an order or claim that signage has been rejected.

PEOPLE / Sam: Administrative assistant | Farah: Meeting chair

CLOSE WITH ACTIONS THAT SURVIVE OUTSIDE THE ROOM

People can leave the same meeting remembering different levels of agreement. Repeat the owner, deliverable, and due date before closing. Distinguish a decision to gather information from a purchase decision, and record a deferred item without making it disappear.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which item does the chair prioritize?

A A new travel policy

C Printer replacement

B A payment dispute

D Visitor signage

2. What can Sam deliver by Thursday?

A Installed visitor signage

C Two quotations

B A guaranteed supplier discount

D An approved printer purchase

3. What is the status of signage?

A Rejected permanently

C Approved for immediate spending

B Already installed

D To be deferred to the next meeting

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

agenda

Ordered list of topics for a meeting.

IN USE work through the agenda

agenda item

Individual topic listed for discussion.

IN USE prioritize an agenda item

chair

Person directing the meeting.

IN USE ask the chair to confirm

time remaining

Amount of meeting time still available.

IN USE state the time remaining

priority item

Topic selected for attention before others.

IN USE identify the priority item

quotation

Supplier statement of a price and relevant terms.

IN USE obtain two quotations

quote gathering

Collecting supplier offers for later comparison.

IN USE assign quote gathering

purchase approval

Permission to buy the specified item.

IN USE distinguish purchase approval

action point

Agreed task arising from a discussion.

IN USE confirm the action point

action owner

Person responsible for completing the stated task.

IN USE name the action owner

deliverable

Specific output that a task is meant to produce.

IN USE define the deliverable

due date

Date by which a stated task should be completed.

IN USE record the due date

Precision check

Sam is the action owner. The deliverable is two quotes, due Thursday. No purchase has been approved. Obtaining prices and terms prepares a later decision; it does not establish supplier selection, an order, or installation.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

minutes

Formal or agreed record of a meeting's proceedings.

IN USE correct the minutes

decision log

Record of decisions and their scope.

IN USE update the decision log

deferred item

Topic moved to a later discussion.

IN USE retain the deferred item

next meeting

Following scheduled discussion in the sequence.

IN USE carry the item to the next meeting

carry forward

Keep an unresolved item for later attention.

IN USE carry forward visitor signage

procurement

Process of obtaining goods or services for an organization.

IN USE distinguish procurement stages

supplier comparison

Review of relevant differences between supplier offers.

IN USE prepare a supplier comparison

budget authority

Permission to commit funds within an identified scope.

IN USE confirm budget authority

motion

Formal proposal presented for a meeting's decision where that procedure applies.

IN USE distinguish a motion from discussion

consensus

Shared agreement among the relevant participants.

IN USE verify consensus

action readback

Spoken summary of the task and its limits.

IN USE give an action readback

open item

Matter not yet resolved or completed.

IN USE preserve an open item

Precision check

Visitor signage is deferred to the next meeting, not rejected or completed. The final ten minutes should produce a precise action record. Do not invent a quotation deadline earlier than Thursday or a new date for the next meeting.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

SIGNAL THE TIME

"We have ten minutes left."

ASK FOR DIRECTION

"Which item should take priority?"

OFFER A BOUNDED ACTION

"I can obtain two quotes by Thursday."

DEFINE THE OUTPUT

"The deliverable is two supplier quotes."

NAME THE COMPETING ITEMS

"Printer replacement and visitor signage are still on the agenda."

CONFIRM THE PRIORITY

"We will use the remaining time for the printer item."

NAME THE OWNER

"Sam will gather the quotations."

KEEP APPROVAL SEPARATE

"No purchase has been approved."

Can obtain

Offers a specific deliverable within the speaker's stated capacity.

By Thursday

Gives the due date rather than the meeting date.

As the action point

Requests confirmation of the task to be recorded.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

AVOID AN ACCIDENTAL ORDER

"Gathering quotes does not authorize me to buy."

RECORD THE DEADLINE

"I will put Thursday in the action record."

AVOID FALSE REJECTION

"Deferred does not mean rejected."

READ BACK THE OUTCOME

"Sam: two quotes by Thursday; purchase not approved."

ASK FOR CONFIRMATION

"Can you confirm that as the action point?"

DEFER TRANSPARENTLY

"Shall we carry signage forward to the next meeting?"

PRESERVE THE OPEN ITEM

"Signage remains on the follow-up agenda."

CLOSE WITH SHARED WORDING

"I will circulate the record with those limits clear."

Does not authorize

Separates preparation from spending permission.

Carry forward

Keeps an item active for later consideration.

With those limits

Preserves the boundary of what was actually agreed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which action record is correct?

- A** Sam to obtain two printer quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved
- B** Sam to buy a printer today
- C** Farah has selected a supplier
- D** Signage installed by Thursday

2. What does deferred mean here?

- A** Removed from all records
- B** Moved to the next meeting
- C** Rejected permanently
- D** Approved for immediate purchase

3. Which question closes the meeting usefully?

- A** May I erase the signage item?
- B** Which supplier did we already order from?
- C** Can you confirm two quotes by Thursday as my action?
- D** Should I assume all spending is approved?

4. Which claim exceeds the agreement?

- A** Sam owns the quote action
- B** Signage remains unresolved
- C** A printer order is authorized
- D** Two quotes are needed

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Two quotes, not permission to buy

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

purchase approval / decision log / deliverable / due date / priority item / action owner / action readback / deferred item / open item / minutes

- 01 **Sam:** We have ten minutes left, and printer replacement and visitor signage are both still on the agenda. Which one should we deal with first?
- 02 **Farah:** Let us make the printer the ¹ _____. We should use the remaining time to establish the next useful action instead of rushing through both subjects.
- 03 **Sam:** I can obtain two supplier quotes by Thursday. That would give us something concrete to compare, although it would not settle which printer to buy.
- 04 **Farah:** That sounds like a clear ² _____. Please keep the output as two quotations. We have not selected a supplier or approved a purchase during this discussion.
- 05 **Sam:** Before I record it, can you confirm that gathering those quotes is my action? I want the minutes to name the person responsible.
- 06 **Farah:** Yes. You are the ³ _____, Sam. The task is to obtain two quotes by Thursday, and the record should not suggest that anyone else has agreed to place an order.
- 07 **Sam:** I will put Thursday against the action. I will not change it to tomorrow simply because the printer feels urgent at the end of the meeting.
- 08 **Farah:** Correct. Thursday is the ⁴ _____ you have offered and we are confirming. An accurate deadline is more useful than a more urgent one that nobody agreed to.
- 09 **Sam:** And the distinction about buying needs to be explicit. Otherwise, a colleague reading the short action list might think the quotes are only a formality.
- 10 **Farah:** Include that there is no ⁵ _____. We are asking for information to support a later decision, not authorizing an order through this action.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Sam:** That leaves visitor signage. Shall I carry it forward to the next meeting rather than squeeze in a decision without enough time to discuss it?
- 12 **Farah:** Yes. Record it as a ⁶ _____. It belongs on the next meeting's agenda; it has not been rejected, completed, or approved for spending.
- 13 **Sam:** I will keep it visible. The last thing we need is for a postponed item to disappear because the final action summary only mentions the printer.
- 14 **Farah:** Agreed. The ⁷ _____ should show both outcomes: a specific printer action and a signage item carried forward. They represent different states, and readers need to see that.
- 15 **Sam:** Let me read the printer action back: Sam will obtain two quotations by Thursday. No purchase is approved, and no supplier has been selected.
- 16 **Farah:** That is an accurate ⁸ _____. Please retain the approval limit with the action rather than leaving it in a separate paragraph that could be overlooked.
- 17 **Sam:** For signage, I will write that it is deferred to the next meeting. I will not invent a meeting date that we have not supplied.
- 18 **Farah:** Exactly. It remains an ⁹ _____, with the next discussion identified but no new date invented. That is enough to preserve the follow-up without creating a false schedule.
- 19 **Sam:** Then the summary has one task with an owner and deadline, plus one item for the next agenda. I can circulate that wording.
- 20 **Farah:** Please do. A useful ¹⁰ _____ distinguishes what we agreed to do from what we have not decided. Those two entries make the meeting outcome clear.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. priority item | 2. deliverable | 3. action owner | 4. due date | 5. purchase approval | 6. deferred item | 7. minutes | 8. action readback | 9. open item | 10. decision log

Close the meeting with a precise action record

F Say it

Complete the action summary. Preserve the quotation task, deadline, and unresolved signage item.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

quotations / Thursday / Sam / deferred

Chair: "The action owner is ¹ _____."

Assistant: "I will obtain two ² _____."

Chair: "The due date is ³ _____."

Assistant: "Visitor signage is ⁴ _____ to the next meeting."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. Sam | 2. quotations | 3. Thursday | 4. deferred

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Correct version, missing permission

A Read the situation

Correct an outdated document message and request appropriate viewing access without independently widening the audience.

Assistant Elena sent version 2 of the visitor guide. Version 3 was approved this morning, and the older guide gives the wrong reception floor. The current guide is in the shared folder, but recipient Kai cannot view it. Elena must identify the correction, direct recipients to approved version 3, and ask the document owner to resolve Kai's viewing access. The correct floor number and the identity of the owner are not supplied; neither should be invented.

PEOPLE / Kai: Guide recipient | Elena: Administrative assistant

OWN THE CORRECTION AND SEPARATE THE ACCESS PROBLEM

An apology should point clearly to the replacement source. A broken permission is a second issue, not a reason to recirculate the inaccurate attachment or make the folder available to everyone. Describe the access needed and route the request to the owner.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which version is current?

- A Version 2 because it was emailed
- B Both versions equally
- C An invented version 4
- D Version 3, approved this morning

2. What is wrong in version 2?

- A The meeting duration
- B The reception floor
- C The supplier quantity
- D A confirmed ticket price

3. Who should resolve Kai's access?

- A Elena by making the folder public
- B Kai by forwarding the old version
- C Any recipient by guessing a password
- D The document owner through the appropriate process

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

document version

Identified revision of a file or publication.

IN USE check the document version

approved version

Revision accepted for the stated use.

IN USE use the approved version

superseded

Replaced by a newer applicable version.

IN USE mark the guide as superseded

current guide

Document presently valid for the intended purpose.

IN USE link to the current guide

shared folder

Storage location available to users with relevant permissions.

IN USE locate the shared folder

document owner

Person responsible for the file and relevant access decisions.

IN USE contact the document owner

viewing access

Permission to open and read the content.

IN USE request viewing access

editing permission

Authority to modify the content.

IN USE distinguish editing permission

access request

Request for an appropriate permission to be granted.

IN USE submit an access request

permission scope

Range of people and actions covered by an access setting.

IN USE preserve permission scope

recipient

Person receiving a message or shared document.

IN USE identify the affected recipient

attachment

File included with a message.

IN USE replace the outdated attachment

Precision check

Version 3 was approved this morning. Version 2 contains the wrong reception floor and should not remain the active guide. The brief does not supply the correct floor number, so the correction must point to the current guide rather than invent directions.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

document link

Address pointing to a stored file.

IN USE share the current document link

version history

Record of changes or saved revisions.

IN USE consult version history

approval date

Date on which the relevant revision was accepted.

IN USE verify the approval date

correction notice

Message identifying an error and its replacement.

IN USE send a correction notice

reception floor

Building level at which the relevant reception is located.

IN USE verify the reception floor

access error

Message or condition preventing permitted use of a resource.

IN USE report an access error

distribution list

Set of recipients for a message or document.

IN USE check the distribution list

unrestricted link

Link that does not limit access to the intended named audience.

IN USE avoid an unrestricted link

read-only

Allowing viewing without permission to change content.

IN USE request read-only access

source location

Place where the authoritative file is stored.

IN USE identify the source location

revision control

Management of document versions and their status.

IN USE maintain revision control

replacement message

Updated communication that corrects an earlier one.

IN USE issue a replacement message

Precision check

Kai needs viewing access, not an assumed right to edit or share with everyone. Elena should ask the document owner to resolve the problem through the appropriate process. A shared folder is not necessarily open to every recipient.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OWN THE ERROR

"I sent version 2 in my earlier message."

IDENTIFY THE AFFECTED DETAIL

"The older guide gives the wrong reception floor."

AVOID GUESSED DIRECTIONS

"I will not quote a floor number I have not verified."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE OBSTACLE

"You are receiving an access error."

NAME THE REPLACEMENT

"Version 3 was approved this morning."

DIRECT RECIPIENTS CLEARLY

"Please use version 3 in the shared folder."

ASK ABOUT ACCESS

"Can you open the current guide?"

NAME THE NEEDED PERMISSION

"You need viewing access to the approved guide."

Superseded

Marks the older version as replaced rather than still equally valid.

Approved this morning

Specifies why version 3 is current.

Can you open ...?

Checks viewing access without asking for an edit.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP EDITING SEPARATE

"Viewing access is not a request for editing rights."

AVOID WIDENING ACCESS

"I will not make the folder available to everyone."

CORRECT THE DISTRIBUTION

"I will send the correction to the affected recipients."

KEEP COMPLETION HONEST

"Access has been requested, not confirmed."

ROUTE THE REQUEST

"I will ask the document owner to resolve the permission."

RETIRE THE OLD REFERENCE

"The earlier attachment is superseded."

PRESERVE THE AUTHORITATIVE SOURCE

"The current file remains in the shared folder."

CLOSE WITH TWO ACTIONS

"Replace the outdated reference and resolve viewing access."

Requested, not confirmed

Distinguishes submission from successful resolution.

Affected recipients

Identifies the relevant audience without expanding distribution.

I will not quote

Prevents guessed location information from entering the correction.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which correction is accurate?

- A** Use either version because both arrived by email
- B** Reception is on an invented floor
- C** Version 4 has automatically replaced both files
- D** Use approved version 3; version 2 has the wrong reception floor

2. What permission does Kai need here?

- A** Permission to edit every file
- B** A public link for anyone
- C** Viewing access
- D** Ownership of the folder

3. Which action exceeds Elena's supplied authority?

- A** Making the folder public
- B** Asking the owner for viewing access
- C** Correcting the earlier message
- D** Identifying version 2 as superseded

4. What should Elena avoid claiming?

- A** Version 2 gives the wrong floor
- B** The owner should receive the request
- C** Kai's access is fixed before confirmation
- D** Version 3 was approved this morning

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Correct version, missing permission

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approved version / current guide / document owner / correction notice / access request / replacement message / access error / permission scope / viewing access / superseded

- 01 **Kai:** I opened the visitor guide you emailed, but I have now seen a message about another version. Which one should I send to my visitors?
- 02 **Elena:** Please use the ¹ _____, version three. I sent version two earlier, and I need to correct that message because its reception-floor information is wrong.
- 03 **Kai:** Thanks for catching it. Could you tell me the correct floor now? I would rather not give visitors contradictory directions as they arrive.
- 04 **Elena:** I need to verify that detail in the ² _____. I will not guess a floor number. The correction should direct everyone to version three in the shared folder.
- 05 **Kai:** I tried the folder link, but it says I do not have permission. The version number is clear now; getting into the file is the problem.
- 06 **Elena:** Understood. You need ³ _____ to the current guide. That is a separate issue from the version correction, and I will ask the document owner to resolve it.
- 07 **Kai:** Could you just change the link so anyone can open it? That would be quick, and I only need to check the reception information.
- 08 **Elena:** I should not widen the ⁴ _____ independently. I will request the appropriate access for you rather than making the folder available to an unrestricted audience.
- 09 **Kai:** Fair enough. I do not need to edit the guide. I only need to read the current instructions and use the right information.
- 10 **Elena:** I will make that distinction explicit in the ⁵ _____. The owner needs to know which approved file you cannot open and that the required action is viewing.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Kai:** While that is being resolved, should I keep the old attachment in the visitor message? At least it is a file I can open.
- 12 **Elena:** No, it is ⁶ _____ and contains a known error. Leaving it as the active guide would continue the incorrect directions. I will clearly withdraw that reference in my correction.
- 13 **Kai:** Please make the subject and wording easy to recognize. There are several visitor messages in the thread, and a quiet edit could be missed.
- 14 **Elena:** I will send a ⁷ _____ identifying the earlier attachment, the reception-floor error, and approved version three. The audience should know which information to stop using.
- 15 **Kai:** Once the owner receives your request, can I tell my colleague the access problem is solved, or should I wait until it actually works?
- 16 **Elena:** Please wait for confirmation. An ⁸ _____ does not disappear simply because a request has been sent. I will describe the request as pending, not completed.
- 17 **Kai:** Then we have two tracks: correct the guide reference for everyone affected, and resolve my ability to open the approved version.
- 18 **Elena:** Exactly. The ⁹ _____ will identify version three as current. The owner's access follow-up will stay separate so neither issue gets lost in the other.
- 19 **Kai:** Thank you. I will not forward the old directions or assume the link is fixed. Please let me know when viewing access is confirmed.
- 20 **Elena:** I will keep the ¹⁰ _____ involved and report the actual status. The correction will remain explicit, and I will not invent a floor number or a completed permission change.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. approved version | 2. current guide | 3. viewing access | 4. permission scope | 5. access request | 6. superseded | 7. correction notice | 8. access error | 9. replacement message | 10. document owner

Correct the guide and request the right access

F Say it

Complete the document handoff. Identify the current version, the known error, and the appropriate permission route.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

floor / viewing / owner / 3

Assistant: "The approved guide is version ¹ _____."

Recipient: "The older version has the wrong reception ² _____."

Assistant: "You need ³ _____ access to the current guide."

Recipient: "Please ask the document ⁴ _____ to resolve it."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. 3 | 2. floor | 3. viewing | 4. owner

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

A Read the situation

Present a documented quantity discrepancy and request the missing supply information without inventing a cause or approving payment.

05

Purchase order P44 is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note also lists twelve, but assistant Omar has checked the shipment and counted ten. No second package or backorder is documented. Supplier contact Leila must receive a factual query asking about the outstanding two and whether another shipment is planned. Omar has no basis to allege theft, assume a split delivery, or approve payment from the information available.

PEOPLE / Omar: Office assistant | Leila: Supplier contact

USE MATCHING REFERENCES AND NEUTRAL DISCREPANCY LANGUAGE

A clear supplier query separates the order, the document, and the checked physical count. Ask for confirmation of the outstanding quantity and delivery position. An unexplained difference is not proof of dishonesty, and a document alone does not establish receipt.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How many archive boxes were ordered?

A Twelve

B Ten

C Two

D Twenty-two

2. What quantity was physically checked?

A An uncounted second package

B Ten boxes

C Twelve boxes

D Two boxes

3. What is documented about a second shipment?

A Nothing is confirmed

B It definitely arrives tomorrow

C It was received yesterday

D It has been canceled by Omar

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

purchase order

Formal order record specifying requested goods or services; abbreviated PO.

IN USE quote the purchase order

archive box

Container used to store records or documents.

IN USE order archive boxes

ordered quantity

Number of units requested on the order.

IN USE verify the ordered quantity

delivery note

Document listing goods associated with a delivery.

IN USE compare the delivery note

checked count

Quantity established by the stated physical check.

IN USE report the checked count

short delivery

Receipt of fewer units than the order or document specifies.

IN USE query a short delivery

quantity discrepancy

Difference between relevant stated or counted quantities.

IN USE report a quantity discrepancy

outstanding quantity

Ordered amount not yet accounted for as received.

IN USE confirm the outstanding quantity

backorder

Order quantity awaiting later fulfillment.

IN USE verify a documented backorder

split shipment

Order delivered in more than one consignment.

IN USE confirm a split shipment

second package

Additional parcel distinct from the checked one.

IN USE verify a second package

shipment plan

Stated arrangement for dispatching the remaining goods.

IN USE request the shipment plan

Precision check

Twelve were ordered and twelve appear on the delivery note, but ten were checked in the shipment. The difference is two. Do not change the checked count to match the paper or claim that the missing two have already been dispatched.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

supplier query

Request to clarify information held by the vendor.

IN USE raise a supplier query

order reference

Identifier connecting an inquiry to the correct order.

IN USE include the order reference

receipt record

Account of goods actually received.

IN USE preserve the receipt record

dispatch record

Information documenting goods sent from the supplier.

IN USE check the dispatch record

packing list

List describing the contents assigned to a package or shipment.

IN USE compare the packing list

unit count

Number of individual items rather than cartons or sets.

IN USE confirm the unit count

fulfillment

Completion of the relevant supply obligation.

IN USE distinguish partial fulfillment

partial receipt

Receipt of only part of the ordered amount.

IN USE record a partial receipt

payment approval

Authorization to pay the relevant charge.

IN USE keep payment approval separate

supplier response

Information returned in answer to the query.

IN USE request a supplier response

unverified explanation

Possible cause not established by the evidence.

IN USE avoid an unverified explanation

delivery reconciliation

Comparison of order, documents, and received quantities.

IN USE complete delivery reconciliation

Precision check

The supplier should confirm the outstanding quantity and whether another shipment is planned. No documented backorder, second package, theft, or payment approval is supplied. Keep the discrepancy open until the relevant evidence resolves it.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE ORDER

"I am calling about purchase order P44."

STATE THE DOCUMENT AMOUNT

"The delivery note also lists twelve."

CALCULATE THE DIFFERENCE

"Two boxes are not accounted for in this receipt."

ASK ABOUT OUTSTANDING SUPPLY

"Can you confirm the outstanding two boxes?"

STATE THE ORDERED AMOUNT

"The order is for twelve archive boxes."

STATE THE CHECKED COUNT

"We checked the shipment and counted ten."

USE NEUTRAL LANGUAGE

"There is a quantity discrepancy to resolve."

CHECK FOR ANOTHER SHIPMENT

"Is a further shipment planned?"

Lists versus counted

Separates what a document says from the physical check.

Not accounted for

Describes an unresolved quantity without assigning blame.

Further shipment

Asks about a possibility without claiming it exists.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID ASSUMING A BACKORDER

"We have no documented backorder."

AVOID INVENTING A PACKAGE

"No second package is recorded."

SEPARATE DOCUMENT AND RECEIPT

"The note lists twelve, but our checked receipt is ten."

REQUEST THE SUPPORTING RECORD

"Please check the dispatch information against P44."

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"We have not established why the quantities differ."

AVOID AN ACCUSATION

"I am reporting the count, not alleging theft."

PRESERVE APPROVAL LIMITS

"This query does not approve payment."

CLOSE WITH THE REQUESTED RESPONSE

"Please confirm the remaining quantity and shipment position."

Against P44

Anchors the check to the correct order.

No documented

Limits the statement to available records rather than claiming absolute impossibility.

Does not approve

Prevents a query from becoming a financial authorization.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement preserves all three quantities?

- A** P44 orders ten and all twelve arrived
- B** The note proves twelve were received
- C** Two additional boxes have definitely shipped
- D** P44 orders twelve, the note lists twelve, and the checked shipment contains ten

2. What is the outstanding difference?

- A** Twenty-two boxes
- B** Two boxes
- C** Twelve boxes
- D** Ten boxes

3. Which question is justified?

- A** Can I record a second delivery as completed?
- B** Which payment have we already approved?
- C** Is another shipment planned for the outstanding two?
- D** Why did your driver steal two boxes?

4. Which record should remain accurate?

- A** An invented receipt of twelve
- B** A confirmed backorder with no evidence
- C** An automatic payment approval
- D** The checked receipt of ten

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Twelve on the note, ten in the shipment

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

supplier query / order reference / supplier response / split shipment / ordered quantity / dispatch record / Payment approval / checked count / outstanding quantity / quantity discrepancy

- 01 **Omar:** I am calling about purchase order P44 for archive boxes. The delivery paperwork and the quantity we received do not match, so I would like you to check.
- 02 **Leila:** Certainly. Please give me the ¹ _____ first, then the delivery-note figure and your checked count. That will help me keep the three records separate.
- 03 **Omar:** The order is for twelve archive boxes. The delivery note lists twelve as well, but I checked the shipment and counted ten boxes.
- 04 **Leila:** Then the ² _____ is two boxes. I will not treat the delivery-note figure as proof that twelve were physically received at your office.
- 05 **Omar:** Thank you. We have no record of a second package or a backorder. I do not want either of those assumed as the explanation.
- 06 **Leila:** Understood. A ³ _____ has not been documented in the information you have. I need to check rather than tell you another package is already on its way.
- 07 **Omar:** Exactly. Could you confirm the outstanding two and whether a further shipment is planned? Those are the two points we need answered.
- 08 **Leila:** I will check the ⁴ _____ against P44 and ask about the shipment position. At this point, I do not have a confirmed dispatch date to give you.
- 09 **Omar:** Please keep the item description as archive boxes. We have several office-supply orders, and a general message about two missing items could become confusing.
- 10 **Leila:** I will retain the ⁵ _____ and the archive-box description together. The query is twelve ordered, twelve on the note, ten checked, with two outstanding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Omar:** Someone suggested I should simply record twelve because that is what the delivery note says. I would rather keep the receiving record factual.
- 12 **Leila:** You should preserve the ⁶ _____ of ten in this query. We need to resolve the mismatch, not make it disappear by replacing the physical count with the document figure.
- 13 **Omar:** That is helpful. I also want the tone to be neutral. We have found a difference, but we have not established why it happened.
- 14 **Leila:** Agreed. The ⁷ _____ can ask for confirmation without alleging theft or blaming a particular person. The current evidence does not establish a cause.
- 15 **Omar:** Will you compare your dispatch information with the order? That may tell us whether the remaining two were held back or require another arrangement.
- 16 **Leila:** I will request the relevant ⁸ _____ check. I will not say the boxes were held back unless the information supports that explanation.
- 17 **Omar:** Good. This call is about the delivery difference. It should not be recorded as my approval to pay for the order or close the discrepancy.
- 18 **Leila:** Understood. ⁹ _____ is not part of this exchange. The query remains open while the outstanding quantity and any further shipment are being confirmed.
- 19 **Omar:** Please respond with those two points clearly separated: what remains outstanding, and whether another shipment is planned. A general received your query message will not settle them.
- 20 **Leila:** I will make the requested ¹⁰ _____ specific to those questions. Until then, the record remains ten received against twelve ordered, with two still unaccounted for.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. ordered quantity | 2. quantity discrepancy | 3. split shipment | 4. outstanding quantity | 5. order reference | 6. checked count | 7. supplier query | 8. dispatch record | 9. Payment approval | 10. supplier response

State the supply discrepancy without guessing

F Say it

Complete the supplier query using the documented order and checked receipt.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ten / two / P44 / twelve

Assistant: "The purchase order is ¹ _____."

Supplier: "The order and delivery note both list ² _____ boxes."

Assistant: "The checked shipment contains ³ _____ boxes."

Supplier: "The outstanding difference is ⁴ _____ boxes."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. P44 | 2. twelve | 3. ten | 4. two

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

A Read the situation

Welcome a visitor, distinguish two possible hosts, and explain the waiting arrangement while preserving the actual access boundary.

Visitor Taylor arrives for a 10:00 meeting with Jordan. Two colleagues share that first name: Jordan Chen in facilities and Jordan Patel in sales. Visitor reference V12 names Jordan Chen. Receptionist Nia must check the reference, contact the correct host, and explain that Taylor should wait at reception. Taylor is not cleared to enter other areas alone. No host arrival time or further access permission has been confirmed.

PEOPLE / Taylor: Visitor | Nia: Receptionist

06

WARMTH AND VERIFICATION BELONG IN THE SAME WELCOME

A friendly reception need not rely on guessing who a visitor means. Explain the small ambiguity, use the appointment reference, and say what happens next. A waiting instruction should sound like a clear arrangement, not a personal suspicion or an invented promise about the host.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which Jordan is named on V12?

A Both Jordans jointly

C Jordan Chen in facilities

B An unnamed finance colleague

D Jordan Patel in sales

2. Where should Taylor wait?

A In any available meeting room

C At reception

B At the sales desk without checking

D Alone in the facilities work area

3. What is not confirmed?

A The scheduled 10:00 meeting

C When the host will reach reception

B The existence of two Jordans

D The reference V12

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

reception

Area where visitors first report and are assisted.

IN USE wait at reception

visitor reference

Identifier linking a visitor to an arrangement.

IN USE check the visitor reference

host

Person responsible for receiving the visitor.

IN USE contact the host

appointment record

Information describing a scheduled visit or meeting.

IN USE check the appointment record

surname

Family name used to distinguish people with the same first name.

IN USE confirm the surname

facilities

Workplace function associated with relevant building services.

IN USE identify the facilities host

sales

Business function associated with selling products or services.

IN USE distinguish the sales colleague

scheduled time

Time recorded for the arranged meeting.

IN USE confirm the scheduled time

arrival

Visitor's appearance at the location.

IN USE acknowledge the arrival

check-in

Initial process for recording or verifying a visitor's arrival.

IN USE complete the check-in

waiting area

Designated place where a person remains before being received.

IN USE explain the waiting area

host notification

Message informing the host that the visitor has arrived.

IN USE send the host notification

Precision check

Reference V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities, not Jordan Patel in sales. The first name alone is insufficient because both colleagues are called Jordan. Preserve the reference and full name when contacting the host.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

access clearance

Confirmed permission to enter a defined area.

IN USE verify access clearance

unaccompanied access

Permission to enter or move without an escort.

IN USE distinguish unaccompanied access

escort

Authorized person accompanying a visitor where required.

IN USE confirm the escort arrangement

visitor badge

Identifier issued under the relevant visitor procedure.

IN USE follow the visitor-badge procedure

visitor log

Record of arrivals and relevant visit details.

IN USE update the visitor log

restricted area

Space whose entry is limited by the applicable rules.

IN USE identify a restricted area

identity match

Agreement between the person or name and the relevant record.

IN USE verify the identity match

appointment ambiguity

Uncertainty about which arrangement or host is intended.

IN USE resolve appointment ambiguity

reception wait

Period spent at reception pending the next arrangement.

IN USE explain the reception wait

host availability

Whether the intended host can presently respond.

IN USE check host availability

arrival estimate

Expected arrival time that has not necessarily been confirmed.

IN USE qualify an arrival estimate

visitor handoff

Transfer of responsibility for receiving the visitor.

IN USE coordinate the visitor handoff

Precision check

The appointment is scheduled for 10:00, but the host's immediate availability has not been confirmed. Taylor should wait at reception and has no clearance to enter other areas alone. Do not invent a two-minute wait, badge requirement, or escort arrival.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN WARMLY

"Good morning. Who are you here to see?"

EXPLAIN THE AMBIGUITY

"We have two colleagues called Jordan."

READ BACK THE IDENTIFIER

"I have V12."

DISTINGUISH THE DEPARTMENT

"Jordan Chen is in facilities, not sales."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE BOOKING

"You have a 10:00 meeting with Jordan."

ASK FOR THE REFERENCE

"May I check your visitor reference?"

CONFIRM THE FULL NAME

"That reference names Jordan Chen."

STATE THE NEXT ACTION

"I will contact your host."

06

We have two

Explains why a clarification is necessary without blaming the visitor.

That reference names

Grounds the identification in a record rather than a guess.

While I contact

Connects the wait with the next action without giving a false duration.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN THE WAIT

"Please wait here at reception while I contact Jordan."

AVOID INVENTED TIMING

"I do not yet have a confirmed arrival time for the host."

SEPARATE APPOINTMENT AND ENTRY

"The meeting reference does not give unaccompanied access."

CHECK THE UNDERSTANDING

"Is the host name on that readback correct?"

KEEP THE TONE HELPFUL

"I want to make sure you reach the correct person."

KEEP ACCESS EXPLICIT

"You are not cleared to enter the other areas alone."

PRESERVE THE RECORD

"I will keep V12 with your arrival message."

CLOSE WITH THE ARRANGEMENT

"Jordan Chen will be contacted; please remain at reception for the next update."

Not yet

States an unresolved fact without denying a possible later arrangement.

Alone

Specifies the unaccompanied-access boundary.

Please remain

Gives a courteous, concrete waiting instruction.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which host message is accurate?

- A** Taylor is meeting Jordan Patel in sales
- B** Both Jordans must attend
- C** Taylor has entered facilities alone
- D** Taylor is at reception for V12 with Jordan Chen at 10:00

2. Which sentence is courteous and accurate?

- A** Your appointment means you can enter alone
- B** Please wait at reception while I contact Jordan Chen
- C** Go anywhere while we look for Jordan
- D** Jordan will definitely be here in two minutes

3. What resolves the first-name ambiguity?

- A** V12 and the full host name
- B** Assuming sales receives every visitor
- C** Choosing the first Jordan in a directory
- D** Treating both names as interchangeable

4. Which fact must remain separate from the booking?

- A** The reference V12
- B** Jordan Chen's department
- C** Permission to enter other areas alone
- D** The scheduled 10:00 meeting

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Two Jordans, one visitor reference

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

waiting area / appointment record / visitor handoff / reception wait / host availability / visitor reference / arrival / host notification / surname / unaccompanied access

06

- 01 **Taylor:** Good morning. I am Taylor, here for my ten o'clock meeting with Jordan. I have the visit confirmation on my phone if you need it.
- 02 **Nia:** Welcome. May I check the ¹ _____? We have two colleagues called Jordan, so I want to contact the right person before directing you anywhere.
- 03 **Taylor:** Of course. The reference is V12. I only remembered the first name when I came in, but the confirmation should have the full details.
- 04 **Nia:** Thank you. The ² _____ names Jordan Chen in facilities. The other colleague is Jordan Patel in sales, so we have resolved that ambiguity.
- 05 **Taylor:** Jordan Chen is right. I am glad you checked; I might have followed directions to sales without realizing there were two people with that name.
- 06 **Nia:** I will send the ³ _____ to Jordan Chen, using V12 and your name. Please wait here at reception while I make contact.
- 07 **Taylor:** Certainly. The meeting is at ten, and I am here now. Do you know whether Jordan is already on the way to meet me?
- 08 **Nia:** I have not confirmed ⁴ _____ yet. I can contact Jordan, but I do not want to promise an arrival time before I have that information.
- 09 **Taylor:** That is fine. I can wait a little. Would it help if I went straight to the facilities area and waited near the office instead?
- 10 **Nia:** Please remain in the ⁵ _____ here for now. You have not been cleared to enter the other areas alone, and I do not want to send you beyond the current arrangement.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Taylor:** Understood. I thought the meeting confirmation might be enough for me to go through, but I can see that is a separate question.
- 12 **Nia:** Yes. The reference identifies your visit; it does not itself establish
⁶ _____. I will keep the next step clear while we contact the correct host.
- 13 **Taylor:** Thank you for explaining it. Please make sure Jordan knows I am already here, rather than simply asking whether the meeting is still happening.
- 14 **Nia:** Certainly. The ⁷ _____ message will say Taylor is at reception for the ten o'clock meeting, reference V12. It will not describe this as a new booking request.
- 15 **Taylor:** That sounds right. I do not need you to find another meeting room; I just want the host to know where to meet me.
- 16 **Nia:** I will keep the ⁸ _____ as the arrangement. No alternative room or entry route has been agreed, so I will not add one to the message.
- 17 **Taylor:** Could you repeat the name and department once more? I would like to use the full name correctly when Jordan arrives.
- 18 **Nia:** Jordan Chen in facilities. Confirming the ⁹ _____ prevents confusion with Jordan Patel in sales. Your reference is V12, and you are waiting here at reception.
- 19 **Taylor:** Excellent. I will stay here for the next update. Thanks for making the process clear without sending me from one department to another.
- 20 **Nia:** You are welcome. I will coordinate the ¹⁰ _____ once the host response is available. For now, the correct host has been identified and the waiting instruction is clear.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. visitor reference | 2. appointment record | 3. host notification | 4. host availability | 5. waiting area | 6. unaccompanied access | 7. arrival | 8. reception wait | 9. surname | 10. visitor handoff

Welcome the visitor and identify the correct host

F Say it

Complete the reception readback using the reference and the actual waiting arrangement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reception / Chen / facilities / V12

Receptionist: "The visitor reference is ¹ _____."

Visitor: "I am meeting Jordan ² _____."

Receptionist: "Your host works in ³ _____."

Visitor: "I will wait at ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. V12 | 2. Chen | 3. facilities | 4. reception

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A higher fare with a conditional refund

A Read the situation

Compare two supplied rail quotes, explain the conditional refund amount, and distinguish a comparison from an approved booking.

Two fictional rail quotes cover the same trip. Option A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable. Option B costs \$90 and permits a refund before departure with a \$10 deduction. Traveler Mira's meeting is not yet confirmed, and purchasing approval is still required. Assistant Ben must compare the quoted terms accurately without choosing for Mira, promising a full refund, or treating the discussion as authority to book.

07

PEOPLE / Mira: Traveler | Ben: Administrative assistant

EXPLAIN THE CONDITION AS CAREFULLY AS THE PRICE

The word refundable can hide a deadline and a deduction. State the upfront price, the condition, and the resulting amount together. A useful comparison helps an authorized decision without turning the assistant's explanation into a booking or financial recommendation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the price difference between the quotes?

A \$20

B \$10

C \$80

D \$160

2. Under the supplied terms, what refund does B permit before departure?

A \$70

B No refund under any circumstances

C \$80

D \$90

3. What must happen before purchase?

A Obtain the required purchasing approval

B Treat this discussion as a booking

C Assume the meeting is confirmed

D Ignore the quoted conditions

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

rail quote

Stated price and conditions for a proposed train journey.

IN USE compare rail quotes

fare

Price charged for the specified travel.

IN USE state the fare

nonrefundable

Not permitting a refund under the stated quoted terms.

IN USE identify a nonrefundable fare

refundable

Permitting a refund subject to the applicable conditions.

IN USE qualify refundable

deduction

Amount subtracted from a payment or refund.

IN USE explain the deduction

before departure

Earlier than the stated leaving time.

IN USE preserve the before-departure condition

refund amount

Sum returned under the applicable refund terms.

IN USE calculate the refund amount

upfront cost

Amount paid at the time of purchase.

IN USE compare upfront costs

price difference

Amount by which one price exceeds another.

IN USE state the price difference

quoted terms

Conditions included in the supplied offer.

IN USE preserve the quoted terms

booking status

Current stage of a travel reservation or purchase.

IN USE clarify booking status

purchasing approval

Required permission to commit the organization to a purchase.

IN USE obtain purchasing approval

07

Precision check

A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable under these quoted terms. B costs \$90 and permits a refund before departure less \$10, leaving \$80. B costs \$20 more upfront; the \$10 deduction is not the price difference.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

unconfirmed meeting

Meeting whose occurrence or arrangement is not yet settled.

IN USE identify the unconfirmed meeting

itinerary

Planned sequence and details of travel.

IN USE check the itinerary

departure

Start of the relevant journey.

IN USE confirm departure details

cancellation

Withdrawal from an existing booking under its terms.

IN USE distinguish cancellation from comparison

refund eligibility

Whether the relevant conditions for a refund are met.

IN USE check refund eligibility

fare condition

Restriction or permission attached to a ticket price.

IN USE explain the fare condition

full refund

Return of the entire relevant payment.

IN USE distinguish a full refund

net refund

Amount returned after the stated deduction.

IN USE calculate the net refund

travel authorization

Approval for travel within a defined scope.

IN USE distinguish travel authorization

reservation

Arrangement holding travel space under specified terms.

IN USE verify a reservation

ticket issuance

Creation or provision of the actual travel ticket.

IN USE distinguish ticket issuance

conditional comparison

Explanation that preserves the conditions affecting the alternatives.

IN USE give a conditional comparison

Precision check

The \$80 refund applies only under the supplied before-departure condition. Do not invent later refund rights, transferability, fees, or legal protections. The meeting is unconfirmed and purchasing approval is still needed; no ticket has been authorized by this comparison.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

DEFINE THE COMPARISON

"Both quotes cover the same trip."

STATE OPTION B

"B costs \$90."

INCLUDE THE DEDUCTION

"The refund is reduced by \$10."

COMPARE UPFRONT PRICES

"B costs \$20 more upfront."

STATE OPTION A

"A costs \$70 and is nonrefundable."

INCLUDE THE CONDITION

"B permits a refund before departure."

CALCULATE THE RETURNED AMOUNT

"Ninety minus ten leaves an \$80 refund."

AVOID A FULL-REFUND CLAIM

"Refundable does not mean the full \$90 comes back."

07

Subject to

Introduces a condition that limits a general statement.

Before departure

Defines when the stated refund permission applies.

Less ten

Expresses the deduction from the ninety-dollar payment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP LATER TERMS OPEN

"No after-departure refund terms are supplied here."

KEEP THE CHOICE SEPARATE

"I can explain the options without choosing for you."

AVOID AN ACCIDENTAL BOOKING

"This comparison is not a ticket purchase."

REQUEST THE NEXT DECISION

"Please confirm the authorized choice before any booking."

PRESERVE MEETING STATUS

"Your meeting is not confirmed yet."

STATE THE APPROVAL REQUIREMENT

"Purchasing approval is still required."

DISTINGUISH THE TWO AMOUNTS

"The \$20 premium and \$10 deduction are different figures."

CLOSE ACCURATELY

"The prices and conditions are clear; the booking remains unapproved."

Upfront

Refers to the initial price rather than a later refund.

Not confirmed yet

Preserves the uncertainty about the travel purpose.

Before any booking

Keeps the approval decision ahead of spending.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is complete?

- A** B is \$90 with a guaranteed full refund anytime
- B** A and B both cost \$80
- C** B costs only \$10 more than A
- D** A is \$70 nonrefundable; B is \$90 with an \$80 refund before departure

2. What does the \$10 represent?

- A** The entire price of option A
- B** The deduction from B's refund
- C** The difference between the fares
- D** A separate confirmed booking fee

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** Approval is required
- B** B is refundable after departure without restrictions
- C** B costs \$90
- D** A costs \$70

4. What is the correct next booking status?

- A** Not approved for purchase yet
- B** Ticket issued automatically
- C** Meeting confirmed by comparing fares
- D** Nonrefundable option purchased by default

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

A higher fare with a conditional refund

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Purchasing approval / nonrefundable / net refund / conditional comparison / fare / upfront cost / unconfirmed meeting / booking status / price difference / before departure

07

- 01 **Mira:** My meeting is still unconfirmed, so I want to understand the two rail quotes before we do anything. They are for the same trip, correct?
- 02 **Ben:** Yes. Option A has a ¹ _____ of seventy dollars, and option B is ninety. The important difference is not only the price but also the refund conditions.
- 03 **Mira:** The cheaper quote says nonrefundable. I take that to mean I cannot get the fare back under the conditions we have been given.
- 04 **Ben:** Correct. A is ² _____ under these quoted terms. For B, a refund is permitted before departure, but ten dollars is deducted from the amount returned.
- 05 **Mira:** So B is not a full ninety-dollar refund. Could you give me the actual amount that would come back under that before-departure condition?
- 06 **Ben:** The ³ _____ would be eighty dollars: ninety less ten. We should state the condition and the deduction together rather than simply describe B as refundable.
- 07 **Mira:** That is useful. I had almost compared seventy with ten, which would have mixed up the ticket price and the amount withheld from a refund.
- 08 **Ben:** Exactly. The ⁴ _____ is seventy for A or ninety for B. The ten-dollar deduction belongs to B's refund terms; it is not B's purchase price.
- 09 **Mira:** Then B costs twenty dollars more at the point of purchase. That is a different comparison from the ten dollars not returned on cancellation.
- 10 **Ben:** Right. The ⁵ _____ is twenty dollars. Keeping those two figures separate prevents a misleading comparison, especially when you are explaining the options to the approver.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Mira:** Does the quote say anything about refunds after departure? I do not want to assume the same arrangement continues whenever someone cancels.
- 12 **Ben:** The supplied condition is ⁶ _____. We have no later refund terms here, so I cannot extend the eighty-dollar calculation to an after-departure cancellation.
- 13 **Mira:** Understood. My meeting has not been confirmed, so I am only gathering the options. Please do not take these questions as an instruction to book.
- 14 **Ben:** I will keep the ⁷ _____ clear. This is a comparison, not a reservation or ticket purchase, and purchasing approval is still required before any commitment.
- 15 **Mira:** Could you summarize the options in a way I can pass to the person who approves travel, without telling them which one I have selected?
- 16 **Ben:** Certainly. The ⁸ _____ is A at seventy, nonrefundable; B at ninety, with an eighty-dollar refund before departure after the ten-dollar deduction.
- 17 **Mira:** Please add that the meeting remains unconfirmed. That uncertainty is why I asked about the conditions, but it does not settle the choice by itself.
- 18 **Ben:** I will preserve the ⁹ _____ status alongside the quotes. The decision-maker should see the actual circumstances, not a message implying that the trip is already settled.
- 19 **Mira:** Good. I will get the decision and approval clarified. For now, we have compared the same trip, the two prices, and the refund limit accurately.
- 20 **Ben:** Agreed. ¹⁰ _____ remains outstanding. I will not issue a ticket or record an authorized choice until the required confirmation is available.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. fare | 2. nonrefundable | 3. net refund | 4. upfront cost | 5. price difference | 6. before departure | 7. booking status | 8. conditional comparison | 9. unconfirmed meeting | 10. Purchasing approval

State the price and the refund condition

F Say it

Complete the comparison using the supplied fares and terms. Do not turn the comparison into a booking.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

eighty / seventy / approval / ninety

Assistant: "Option A costs ¹ _____ dollars."

Traveler: "Option B costs ² _____ dollars."

Assistant: "Before departure, B permits an ³ _____-dollar refund."

Traveler: "Purchasing ⁴ _____ is still required."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. seventy | 2. ninety | 3. eighty | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

A Read the situation

Explain a capacity conflict with concrete timings and ask the manager to select a priority or change a deadline.

At 10:00, assistant Rosa has a visitor list due at 10:30 and a room pack due at 11:00. Each requires thirty minutes. Manager Ellis requests a new twenty-minute spreadsheet check by 10:20. No colleague is available to help. Rosa must explain the conflict and ask Ellis to choose priorities or adjust a deadline. The case ends with that decision still needed; Rosa cannot truthfully promise all three original deadlines.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Administrative assistant | Ellis: Manager

08

MAKE THE TRADE-OFF CONCRETE, NOT PERSONAL

Saying that you are busy does not show which commitment will move. State the existing deadlines and task durations, then ask for a priority decision. Respectful pushback gives the manager an accurate choice without silently accepting an impossible schedule or delegating to an unavailable colleague.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is due at 10:30?

A The visitor list

B The room pack

C The new spreadsheet check

D An already completed handover

2. How much work is requested in total?

A Sixty minutes

B Thirty minutes

C Twenty minutes

D Eighty minutes

3. What should Rosa ask Ellis to do?

A Treat the durations as zero

B Choose priorities or adjust a deadline

C Assume all three will be on time

D Assign the work to an unavailable colleague

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

workload

Amount of work assigned or awaiting completion.

IN USE explain the workload

capacity

Available ability or time to carry out work.

IN USE state the capacity limit

priority decision

Choice about which task takes precedence.

IN USE request a priority decision

deadline

Latest required completion time for a task.

IN USE clarify the deadline

task duration

Time needed to perform the stated work.

IN USE specify task duration

visitor list

Record of expected visitors for the relevant arrangement.

IN USE prepare the visitor list

room pack

Set of materials prepared for use in the meeting room.

IN USE assemble the room pack

spreadsheet check

Review of the specified spreadsheet information.

IN USE perform the spreadsheet check

competing request

New demand that conflicts with existing commitments.

IN USE identify the competing request

time window

Period within which work must be performed.

IN USE define the available time window

sequence

Order in which tasks are carried out.

IN USE agree the task sequence

trade-off

Consequence of choosing one priority at the expense of another.

IN USE explain the trade-off

Precision check

At 10:00, the original two tasks already require the full sixty minutes until 11:00. The new check adds twenty minutes and is due at 10:20. Doing it first moves the earliest visitor-list finish to 10:50, beyond its 10:30 deadline.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

revised deadline

Newly agreed completion requirement.

IN USE obtain a revised deadline

displaced task

Work moved later because another task takes its place.

IN USE identify the displaced task

coverage

Availability of another person to handle work during the relevant period.

IN USE confirm coverage

delegation

Assignment of a task to someone with the relevant availability and authority.

IN USE avoid unsupported delegation

commitment

Promise to complete a defined action under stated conditions.

IN USE make a realistic commitment

overcommitment

Acceptance of more work than the available capacity permits.

IN USE avoid overcommitment

schedule impact

Effect of a change on task timing.

IN USE explain the schedule impact

earliest finish

First possible completion time under the stated sequence and durations.

IN USE calculate the earliest finish

existing obligation

Task already required before the new request arrives.

IN USE preserve existing obligations

reprioritization

Change to the order or importance of assigned work.

IN USE request reprioritization

handover coverage

Confirmed support for taking over specified work.

IN USE verify handover coverage

decision readback

Repetition of the chosen priority and its consequences.

IN USE prepare a decision readback

08

Precision check

If the sequence is spreadsheet, visitor list, then room pack, the finish times are 10:20, 10:50, and 11:20. These are consequences, not newly approved deadlines. No colleague is available, and Ellis has not yet chosen which commitment should change.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE REQUEST

"I understand you need the spreadsheet check by 10:20."

STATE THE FIRST DEADLINE

"The visitor list is due at 10:30."

GIVE THE DURATIONS

"Each existing task needs thirty minutes."

SHOW THE CAPACITY CONFLICT

"That is eighty minutes of work between 10:00 and 11:00."

NAME THE EXISTING WORK

"The visitor list and room pack are already due this morning."

STATE THE SECOND DEADLINE

"The room pack is due at 11:00."

ADD THE NEW DEMAND

"The spreadsheet check adds twenty minutes."

STATE THE IMMEDIATE CONSEQUENCE

"If I do the check first, the visitor list cannot finish before 10:50."

08

If I do ... first

Introduces a specific scheduling consequence rather than a refusal.

Cannot finish before

States an earliest completion under the given durations.

Would also

Extends the same conditional sequence to the later task.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP CONSEQUENCES CONDITIONAL

"That sequence would also move the room pack to 11:20."

ASK FOR A DECISION

"Which task should take priority?"

PRESERVE PRIOR COMMITMENTS

"I need to know which existing commitment should move."

REQUEST EXPLICIT AGREEMENT

"Please confirm the revised priority or deadline."

AVOID IMAGINARY HELP

"No colleague is available to take over a task."

OFFER THE RELEVANT ALTERNATIVE

"Can one of the deadlines be adjusted?"

AVOID VAGUE ASSENT

"I cannot confirm all three original deadlines."

CLOSE WITHOUT PRETENDING

"The schedule change still needs your decision."

08

Which should move?

Asks for a decision about the affected commitment.

No colleague is available

Removes delegation as an invented solution.

Still needs

Keeps an unresolved decision visible in the handoff.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. If Rosa does the check first, when can the visitor list finish at the earliest?

- A** 11:20
- B** 10:50
- C** 10:20
- D** 10:30

2. If that sequence continues with the room pack, when does it finish?

- A** 11:20
- B** 10:50
- C** 11:00
- D** 10:20

3. Which response is professionally clear?

- A** I need a priority choice or an adjusted deadline because these tasks require eighty minutes
- B** I will somehow meet every original deadline
- C** Another colleague will do it despite being unavailable
- D** The visitor list no longer matters without asking

4. What remains unresolved at the end of the case?

- A** Whether a colleague is available
- B** The original visitor-list deadline
- C** Which priority or deadline Ellis will change
- D** The stated task durations

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Eighty minutes of work in a sixty-minute window

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

competing request / visitor list / revised deadline / task duration / coverage / overcommitment / schedule impact / decision readback / priority decision / time window

08

- 01 **Ellis:** Can you check the spreadsheet by ten twenty? It should take twenty minutes, and I would like that finished before we move on to the next discussion.
- 02 **Rosa:** I understand the ¹ _____. Before I confirm, I need to show you what is already due, because it is ten now and the timings overlap.
- 03 **Ellis:** What else is scheduled? I knew you were preparing the room materials, but I did not have the visitor-list deadline in front of me.
- 04 **Rosa:** The ² _____ is due at ten thirty and needs thirty minutes. The room pack is due at eleven and also needs thirty minutes.
- 05 **Ellis:** So those two tasks fill the next hour if you do them one after the other. Where would the spreadsheet fit if you started it immediately?
- 06 **Rosa:** It would use the first twenty minutes of the ³ _____. The check could finish at ten twenty, but the visitor list could then finish no earlier than ten fifty.
- 07 **Ellis:** That would miss ten thirty. Could you shorten the visitor-list work enough to recover the time, or is thirty minutes the duration we need to use?
- 08 **Rosa:** Thirty minutes is the stated ⁴ _____. I should not promise a shorter task without a basis for doing so. The room pack also requires its full thirty minutes.
- 09 **Ellis:** If you then did the room pack after the visitor list, I assume that would finish at eleven twenty rather than eleven.
- 10 **Rosa:** Yes. That is the ⁵ _____ of putting the check first and keeping the two original tasks in that order. Those are calculated consequences, not revised deadlines we have agreed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Ellis:** Is anyone free to take the room pack while you work on the spreadsheet? That might preserve the original timing without moving the visitor list.
- 12 **Rosa:** No colleague is available, so we do not have ⁶ _____ for that option. I need us to choose a priority or adjust a deadline rather than assume a handover that cannot happen.
- 13 **Ellis:** I see. Simply adding urgent to the spreadsheet request does not tell you what to do about the other two commitments.
- 14 **Rosa:** Exactly. I need a ⁷ _____. Which task should take precedence, and which existing deadline may move if the spreadsheet check needs to come first?
- 15 **Ellis:** Let me look at the consequences before I answer. I do not want you to silently abandon the visitor list while I assume all three items are covered.
- 16 **Rosa:** Thank you. A ⁸ _____ would need explicit agreement. At present, the visitor list remains due at ten thirty and the room pack at eleven.
- 17 **Ellis:** Then please do not describe the new request as fully accepted yet. I still need to decide which commitment can change.
- 18 **Rosa:** Understood. I will avoid ⁹ _____. The work totals eighty minutes, and I cannot truthfully confirm all three original deadlines within the available hour.
- 19 **Ellis:** That is clear. Keep the durations and the two possible late finishes in front of us while I make the priority decision.
- 20 **Rosa:** I will. Once you choose, I can give a ¹⁰ _____ of the agreed sequence and changed commitment. For now, that decision remains outstanding.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. competing request | 2. visitor list | 3. time window | 4. task duration | 5. schedule impact | 6. coverage | 7. priority decision | 8. revised deadline | 9. overcommitment | 10. decision readback

Ask for a realistic priority decision

F Say it

Complete the workload readback. Keep calculated finish times separate from approved deadline changes.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

eighty / 10:30 / decision / 10:50

08

Assistant: "The three tasks require ¹ _____ minutes in total."

Manager: "The visitor list is originally due at ² _____."

Assistant: "If the check comes first, the list finishes no earlier than ³ _____."

Manager: "A priority ⁴ _____ is still needed."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. eighty | 2. 10:30 | 3. 10:50 | 4. decision

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What is missing from the initial request?

D. Whose local time 3:00 refers to

The request supplies a clock time but does not identify the intended office reference.

2. What equivalence is supplied for this date?

C. 3:00 in Maya's office equals noon at the other office

The brief explicitly gives the date-specific relationship between the two local times.

3. What should happen before invitations are sent?

A. Confirm the intended time reference

Clarifying the intended office time is necessary before sending the invitation.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which clarification is best?

C. Does 3:00 refer to your office or the other office?

The question directly resolves the missing location reference for the requested time.

2. Which readback preserves the supplied equivalence?

B. Your office at 3:00; the other office at noon

The readback matches the date-specific local times given in the brief.

3. What does calendar availability establish?

D. The relevant slot is open, not that the intended time is confirmed

Availability concerns the calendar slot rather than intention, duration, or acceptance.

4. Which detail must not be invented?

C. A one-hour meeting duration

The brief provides no duration from which a one-hour meeting could be established.

01 Conversation answers

Scheduling across calendars and time zones

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

1. time reference. Turn 2. Time reference identifies which office's clock gives the requested three o'clock its intended meaning.

2. equivalent time. Turn 4. Equivalent time is noon in the other office when Maya's office shows three.

3. local time. Turn 6. Local time refers to each office's own clock display for the same meeting moment.

4. calendar availability. Turn 8. Calendar availability confirms an open slot but does not supply the missing duration or location.

5. meeting request. Turn 10. Meeting request remains a proposal whose details must be confirmed before an invitation is issued.

6. date-specific. Turn 12. Date-specific limits the supplied equivalence to the fictional meeting date rather than every future meeting.

7. Acceptance. Turn 14. Acceptance is an attendee's agreement to an invitation, distinct from a calendar appearing open.

8. invitation. Turn 16. Invitation is the attendance request that should contain confirmed scheduling details without assuming prior acceptance.

9. schedule readback. Turn 18. Schedule readback repeats both equivalent office times and preserves that invitations have not yet been sent.

10. Recurrence. Turn 20. Recurrence describes a repeating schedule, which Maya has not authorized in the current request.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. time

Assistant: "Whose local time do you mean?"

Time is the ambiguous reference that must be attached to an office.

2. noon

Colleague: "Three in my office equals noon at the other office."

Noon is the supplied equivalent for the fictional meeting date.

3. open

Assistant: "Both calendars are open at that time."

Open describes availability without establishing that an invitation has been accepted.

4. sending

Colleague: "Confirm the remaining details before sending."

Sending must follow clarification rather than precede the missing details.

02 Briefing and language checks

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which team does Lena need?

A. Facilities

The call concerns delivery D18 and is explicitly for facilities.

2. What is the facilities extension?

D. 214

The supplied internal telephone extension for facilities is 214.

3. How should before 4:00 be recorded?

D. A requested callback deadline

Lena requests the callback, but the team's availability is unknown.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which message is accurate?

D. Lena Park requests facilities about delivery D18, callback before 4:00

The correct message preserves the caller, team, reference, and requested timing.

2. Which response overpromises?

B. They will definitely call before four

The team's unknown availability cannot support a definite callback promise.

3. What should Dev ask before closing?

B. The preferred contact route and relevant details

A useful callback message needs a verified way to reach the caller.

4. Which number should Dev associate with facilities?

C. Extension 214

The brief supplies 214 specifically as the facilities telephone extension.

02 Conversation answers

Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. purpose of call.** Turn 2. Purpose of call distinguishes the delivery inquiry from an invoice matter before Dev routes it.
- 2. delivery reference.** Turn 4. Delivery reference is D18 and should not be relabeled as an invoice identifier.
- 3. callback request.** Turn 6. Callback request records Lena's wish for a return call without promising the team's response time.
- 4. requested deadline.** Turn 8. Requested deadline preserves before four as Lena's timing request, distinct from an accepted commitment.
- 5. preferred contact route.** Turn 10. Preferred contact route is a telephone call, as Lena chooses during the exchange.
- 6. caller identity.** Turn 12. Caller identity is Lena Park, keeping this message distinct from other callers and deliveries.
- 7. extension.** Turn 14. Extension identifies the internal telephone number 214, which Dev corrects without changing the delivery reference.
- 8. message readback.** Turn 16. Message readback combines the caller, intended team, delivery reference, route, and requested deadline for confirmation.
- 9. handoff note.** Turn 18. Handoff note must preserve a facilities delivery inquiry rather than inventing a finance approval request.
- 10. response commitment.** Turn 20. Response commitment would require confirmation from the relevant team, which Dev does not currently have.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. facilities

Assistant: "Lena needs the facilities team."

Facilities handles the stated inquiry, not finance or payroll.

2. D18

Caller: "The delivery reference is D18."

D18 identifies the delivery discussed in this telephone message.

3. 214

Assistant: "The team extension is 214."

214 is the supplied facilities extension, not the delivery identifier.

4. deadline

Caller: "Before 4:00 is my requested deadline."

Deadline preserves the requested timing without asserting that the team has accepted it.

03 Briefing and language checks

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which item does the chair prioritize?

C. Printer replacement

Farah prioritizes the printer item during the final ten minutes.

2. What can Sam deliver by Thursday?

C. Two quotations

The supplied action is to obtain two quotes by Thursday.

3. What is the status of signage?

D. To be deferred to the next meeting

Deferral moves the item to a later meeting without resolving its substance.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which action record is correct?

A. Sam to obtain two printer quotes by Thursday; no purchase approved

The record names the owner, deliverable, deadline, and purchase-approval limit.

2. What does deferred mean here?

B. Moved to the next meeting

Deferral postpones discussion without deciding or deleting the item.

3. Which question closes the meeting usefully?

C. Can you confirm two quotes by Thursday as my action?

The question verifies the bounded task that Sam can actually carry out.

4. Which claim exceeds the agreement?

C. A printer order is authorized

The brief explicitly states that no purchase has been approved.

03 Conversation answers

Preparing meetings and confirming action points

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. priority item.** Turn 2. Priority item is printer replacement, which Farah selects for the remaining meeting time.
- 2. deliverable.** Turn 4. Deliverable is two supplier quotes, not a selected or purchased printer.
- 3. action owner.** Turn 6. Action owner is Sam, who has offered to obtain the two quotations.
- 4. due date.** Turn 8. Due date is Thursday, the stated deadline for the two-quote deliverable.
- 5. purchase approval.** Turn 10. Purchase approval has not been given, so obtaining quotations must not be recorded as permission to buy.
- 6. deferred item.** Turn 12. Deferred item keeps visitor signage for the next meeting without treating it as rejected or completed.
- 7. minutes.** Turn 14. Minutes should preserve both the confirmed quote action and the unresolved signage item.
- 8. action readback.** Turn 16. Action readback confirms Sam, two quotations, Thursday, and the absence of purchase approval together.
- 9. open item.** Turn 18. Open item identifies signage as unresolved despite its move to the next meeting.
- 10. decision log.** Turn 20. Decision log records what was actually agreed, including the boundary between preparation and spending authority.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. Sam

Chair: "The action owner is Sam."

Sam is the assistant who offered and accepted the quote-gathering task.

2. quotations

Assistant: "I will obtain two quotations."

Quotations are the deliverable, not an approved printer purchase.

3. Thursday

Chair: "The due date is Thursday."

Thursday is the explicitly agreed deadline for obtaining the quotes.

4. deferred

Assistant: "Visitor signage is deferred to the next meeting."

Deferred postpones discussion without rejecting, approving, or completing the signage item.

04 Briefing and language checks

Checking document versions and access

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. Which version is current?

D. Version 3, approved this morning

Version 3 is the approved current guide, despite the earlier email.

2. What is wrong in version 2?

B. The reception floor

The brief identifies the reception-floor information as the outdated error.

3. Who should resolve Kai's access?

D. The document owner through the appropriate process

The request belongs with the document owner, not an unauthorized expansion of permissions.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which correction is accurate?

D. Use approved version 3; version 2 has the wrong reception floor

The correction identifies the actual current version and the known error.

2. What permission does Kai need here?

C. Viewing access

The stated problem concerns opening the guide, not editing or unrestricted sharing.

3. Which action exceeds Elena's supplied authority?

A. Making the folder public

Independently widening permissions is explicitly outside the supplied task.

4. What should Elena avoid claiming?

C. Kai's access is fixed before confirmation

A request for access does not prove that access has been granted or tested.

04 Conversation answers

Checking document versions and access

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. approved version.** Turn 2. Approved version is version 3, accepted this morning and replacing the outdated guide Elena sent.
- 2. current guide.** Turn 4. Current guide is the authoritative version 3, which should supply the floor rather than Elena guessing.
- 3. viewing access.** Turn 6. Viewing access is the permission Kai needs to open the approved guide without requesting editing authority.
- 4. permission scope.** Turn 8. Permission scope defines who can access the file, and Elena must not expand it independently.
- 5. access request.** Turn 10. Access request should ask for Kai's viewing permission, not unnecessary editing or public-sharing rights.
- 6. superseded.** Turn 12. Superseded means version 2 has been replaced and should not remain the active source of visitor directions.
- 7. correction notice.** Turn 14. Correction notice explicitly identifies the outdated message and directs recipients to the approved replacement.
- 8. access error.** Turn 16. Access error remains unresolved until the appropriate permission is established and access is confirmed.
- 9. replacement message.** Turn 18. Replacement message corrects the earlier communication while the separate viewing-access request remains visible.
- 10. document owner.** Turn 20. Document owner is the appropriate contact for resolving the requested viewing permission without unauthorized sharing.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 3

Assistant: "The approved guide is version 3."

Version 3 was approved this morning and supersedes the earlier attachment.

2. floor

Recipient: "The older version has the wrong reception floor."

Floor is the specific outdated detail identified in the brief.

3. viewing

Assistant: "You need viewing access to the current guide."

Viewing allows the required reading without assuming editing or public-sharing rights.

4. owner

Recipient: "Please ask the document owner to resolve it."

Owner is the appropriate role for the access request under the supplied instructions.

05 Briefing and language checks

Querying office supplies and delivery differences

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. How many archive boxes were ordered?

A. Twelve

Purchase order P44 explicitly requests twelve archive boxes.

2. What quantity was physically checked?

B. Ten boxes

Omar checked the shipment and found ten rather than the twelve listed.

3. What is documented about a second shipment?

A. Nothing is confirmed

No second package or backorder is documented in the supplied facts.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which statement preserves all three quantities?

D. P44 orders twelve, the note lists twelve, and the checked shipment contains ten

The correct statement keeps the order, delivery document, and physical count distinct.

2. What is the outstanding difference?

B. Two boxes

Twelve ordered minus ten counted leaves two boxes unaccounted for.

3. Which question is justified?

C. Is another shipment planned for the outstanding two?

The question seeks missing supply information without inventing a cause or status.

4. Which record should remain accurate?

D. The checked receipt of ten

The receipt record must preserve the actual checked quantity despite the document discrepancy.

05 Conversation answers

Querying office supplies and delivery differences

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. ordered quantity. Turn 2. Ordered quantity is twelve archive boxes, the amount specified on purchase order P44.

2. quantity discrepancy. Turn 4. Quantity discrepancy is the difference between twelve ordered and documented and ten physically checked.

3. split shipment. Turn 6. Split shipment would mean more than one consignment, but no such arrangement is documented here.

4. outstanding quantity. Turn 8. Outstanding quantity is the two ordered boxes not yet accounted for in the checked receipt.

5. order reference. Turn 10. Order reference P44 links the archive-box discrepancy to the correct supply transaction.

6. checked count. Turn 12. Checked count is ten, and it must not be changed merely to match the delivery paperwork.

7. supplier query. Turn 14. Supplier query requests clarification of the missing supply facts without accusing anyone of wrongdoing.

8. dispatch record. Turn 16. Dispatch record may clarify what was sent, but its contents have not yet been confirmed in the conversation.

9. Payment approval. Turn 18. Payment approval is separate from the supply query and has not been given by Omar.

10. supplier response. Turn 20. Supplier response should address both the outstanding two boxes and the unconfirmed further-shipment position.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. P44

Assistant: "The purchase order is P44."

P44 identifies the archive-box order being queried with the supplier.

2. twelve

Supplier: "The order and delivery note both list twelve boxes."

Twelve is the documented ordered quantity and delivery-note quantity.

3. ten

Assistant: "The checked shipment contains ten boxes."

Ten is the actual checked receipt and must remain distinct from the paperwork.

4. two

Supplier: "The outstanding difference is two boxes."

Two is the difference between twelve ordered and ten physically checked.

06 Briefing and language checks

Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which Jordan is named on V12?

C. Jordan Chen in facilities

The visitor reference explicitly identifies Jordan Chen in facilities.

2. Where should Taylor wait?

C. At reception

Taylor has not been cleared to enter other areas alone.

3. What is not confirmed?

C. When the host will reach reception

No host arrival time is provided in the supplied information.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which host message is accurate?

D. Taylor is at reception for V12 with Jordan Chen at 10:00

The message retains the visitor, reference, host, time, and current waiting location.

2. Which sentence is courteous and accurate?

B. Please wait at reception while I contact Jordan Chen

The instruction states the supplied waiting arrangement without inventing timing or access.

3. What resolves the first-name ambiguity?

A. V12 and the full host name

The appointment reference identifies the specific Jordan intended for this visit.

4. Which fact must remain separate from the booking?

C. Permission to enter other areas alone

A meeting arrangement does not itself establish the supplied unaccompanied-access permission.

06 Conversation answers

Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. visitor reference.** Turn 2. Visitor reference V12 identifies the intended arrangement and resolves which Jordan is the host.
- 2. appointment record.** Turn 4. Appointment record for V12 names Jordan Chen in facilities for the scheduled ten o'clock meeting.
- 3. host notification.** Turn 6. Host notification tells Jordan Chen that Taylor has arrived and is waiting at reception.
- 4. host availability.** Turn 8. Host availability is not established merely because the appointment is scheduled for ten.
- 5. waiting area.** Turn 10. Waiting area is reception, where Taylor should remain pending the next arrangement.
- 6. unaccompanied access.** Turn 12. Unaccompanied access is separate from the meeting reference and has not been granted to Taylor.
- 7. arrival.** Turn 14. Arrival is the fact that Taylor is presently at reception, not merely a future appointment inquiry.
- 8. reception wait.** Turn 16. Reception wait is the agreed current arrangement, without inventing another room or host arrival estimate.
- 9. surname.** Turn 18. Surname Chen distinguishes the intended host from Jordan Patel in sales.
- 10. visitor handoff.** Turn 20. Visitor handoff concerns the next confirmed reception arrangement rather than an assumed right to enter alone.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. V12

Receptionist: "The visitor reference is V12."

V12 identifies Taylor's meeting arrangement with the intended host.

2. Chen

Visitor: "I am meeting Jordan Chen."

Chen distinguishes the facilities host from Jordan Patel in sales.

3. facilities

Receptionist: "Your host works in facilities."

Facilities is the department associated with Jordan Chen in the supplied record.

4. reception

Visitor: "I will wait at reception."

Reception is the stated waiting location until the next arrangement is confirmed.

07 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying travel options and booking status

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is the price difference between the quotes?

A. \$20

Option B costs \$90 and option A costs \$70, so the difference is \$20.

2. Under the supplied terms, what refund does B permit before departure?

C. \$80

The \$90 fare less the stated \$10 deduction leaves an \$80 refund before departure.

3. What must happen before purchase?

A. Obtain the required purchasing approval

Purchasing approval is explicitly still required before the assistant can book.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which comparison is complete?

D. A is \$70 nonrefundable; B is \$90 with an \$80 refund before departure

The comparison retains both prices and B's conditional refund after the deduction.

2. What does the \$10 represent?

B. The deduction from B's refund

The supplied \$10 is subtracted from B's \$90 refund, not from the price comparison.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. B is refundable after departure without restrictions

The supplied terms establish a before-departure refund only, with no later rule provided.

4. What is the correct next booking status?

A. Not approved for purchase yet

The brief explicitly leaves the purchasing approval and meeting confirmation unresolved.

07 Conversation answers

Clarifying travel options and booking status

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. fare.** Turn 2. Fare is the upfront travel price: seventy dollars for A and ninety dollars for B.
- 2. nonrefundable.** Turn 4. Nonrefundable describes option A under the supplied quoted terms without inventing additional exceptions.
- 3. net refund.** Turn 6. Net refund is eighty dollars after subtracting the stated ten-dollar deduction from B's ninety-dollar fare.
- 4. upfront cost.** Turn 8. Upfront cost is the purchase price, separate from the amount retained if a conditional refund occurs.
- 5. price difference.** Turn 10. Price difference is twenty dollars because the quoted fares are ninety and seventy dollars.
- 6. before departure.** Turn 12. Before departure is the stated refund condition, and no after-departure permission is supplied.
- 7. booking status.** Turn 14. Booking status remains unapproved because a comparison and questions do not authorize a purchase.
- 8. conditional comparison.** Turn 16. Conditional comparison presents the two prices and B's limited refund without choosing or booking for Mira.
- 9. unconfirmed meeting.** Turn 18. Unconfirmed meeting describes the unresolved travel purpose without converting it into a recommendation or cancellation.
- 10. Purchasing approval.** Turn 20. Purchasing approval is the missing authorization required before Ben can turn the comparison into a booking.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. seventy

Assistant: "Option A costs seventy dollars."

Seventy is the nonrefundable option's stated upfront price.

2. ninety

Traveler: "Option B costs ninety dollars."

Ninety is B's purchase price before any later conditional refund.

3. eighty

Assistant: "Before departure, B permits an eighty-dollar refund."

Eighty is ninety minus the stated ten-dollar refund deduction.

4. approval

Traveler: "Purchasing approval is still required."

Approval remains necessary because discussing the alternatives does not authorize a ticket purchase.



08 Briefing and language checks

Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is due at 10:30?

A. The visitor list

The visitor list has the earliest of the two original deadlines.

2. How much work is requested in total?

D. Eighty minutes

Two thirty-minute tasks plus a twenty-minute check total eighty minutes.

3. What should Rosa ask Ellis to do?

B. Choose priorities or adjust a deadline

The supplied capacity conflict requires a decision about priorities or timing.

D Language checks / page 72

1. If Rosa does the check first, when can the visitor list finish at the earliest?

B. 10:50

Twenty minutes for the check plus thirty for the list gives a 10:50 finish.

2. If that sequence continues with the room pack, when does it finish?

A. 11:20

The check and two thirty-minute tasks require eighty minutes from 10:00.

3. Which response is professionally clear?

A. I need a priority choice or an adjusted deadline because these tasks require eighty minutes

The response states the capacity conflict and asks the manager for an explicit decision.

4. What remains unresolved at the end of the case?

C. Which priority or deadline Ellis will change

The case supplies the conflict but does not provide Ellis's final priority decision.

08 Conversation answers

Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. competing request. Turn 2. Competing request is the new twenty-minute spreadsheet check that conflicts with Rosa's existing commitments.

2. visitor list. Turn 4. Visitor list is due at 10:30 and requires thirty minutes, so it occupies the first available half hour.

3. time window. Turn 6. Time window from 10:00 to 11:00 contains sixty minutes, less than the eighty minutes of requested work.

4. task duration. Turn 8. Task duration is thirty minutes for each existing task and cannot be silently reduced to make the schedule fit.

5. schedule impact. Turn 10. Schedule impact is a 10:50 list finish followed by an 11:20 room-pack finish if the spreadsheet goes first.

6. coverage. Turn 12. Coverage would require another available person, which the supplied situation explicitly lacks.

7. priority decision. Turn 14. Priority decision determines which task takes precedence and which existing commitment must change.

8. revised deadline. Turn 16. Revised deadline must be explicitly agreed rather than inferred from Rosa's explanation of the conflict.

9. overcommitment. Turn 18. Overcommitment would be promising all three original deadlines despite eighty minutes of work in the available hour.

10. decision readback. Turn 20. Decision readback follows an actual priority decision; no revised sequence or deadline is approved yet.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. eighty

Assistant: "The three tasks require eighty minutes in total."

Eighty combines the two thirty-minute tasks and the new twenty-minute check.

2. 10:30

Manager: "The visitor list is originally due at 10:30."

10:30 remains the original deadline until a change is explicitly agreed.

3. 10:50

Assistant: "If the check comes first, the list finishes no earlier than 10:50."

10:50 follows twenty minutes for the check and thirty for the visitor list.

4. decision

Manager: "A priority decision is still needed."

Decision remains outstanding because no changed priority or deadline has been approved.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Scheduling across calendars and time zones

Clarify the reference: Do you mean 3:00 in your office or the other office?

State availability: Both calendars are open at that equivalent time.

Read back the other clock: That will be noon in the other office.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Taking useful calls and passing accurate messages

Clarify the purpose: Is this about the delivery or an invoice?

Read back the identifier: That is D18, D followed by eighteen.

Verify the details: May I check the contact details for that route?

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Preparing meetings and confirming action points

Signal the time: We have ten minutes left.

Confirm the priority: We will use the remaining time for the printer item.

Keep approval separate: No purchase has been approved.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Checking document versions and access

Own the error: I sent version 2 in my earlier message.

Direct recipients clearly: Please use version 3 in the shared folder.

Name the needed permission: You need viewing access to the approved guide.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Querying office supplies and delivery differences

Identify the order: I am calling about purchase order P44.

State the checked count: We checked the shipment and counted ten.

Check for another shipment: Is a further shipment planned?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Welcoming visitors and checking arrangements

Open warmly: Good morning. Who are you here to see?

Ask for the reference: May I check your visitor reference?

State the next action: I will contact your host.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Clarifying travel options and booking status

Define the comparison: Both quotes cover the same trip.

Include the condition: B permits a refund before departure.

Avoid a full-refund claim: Refundable does not mean the full \$90 comes back.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Prioritizing work and handing over coverage

Acknowledge the request: I understand you need the spreadsheet check by 10:20.

State the second deadline: The room pack is due at 11:00.

State the immediate consequence: If I do the check first, the visitor list cannot finish before 10:50.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance confirm acceptance	6
access clearance verify access clearance	51
access error report an access error	33
access request submit an access request	32
action owner name the action owner	23
action point confirm the action point	23
action readback give an action readback	24
agenda work through the agenda	23
agenda item prioritize an agenda item	23
appointment ambiguity resolve appointment ambiguity	51
appointment record check the appointment record	50
approval date verify the approval date	33
approved version use the approved version	32
archive box order archive boxes	41
arrival acknowledge the arrival	50
arrival estimate qualify an arrival estimate	51
attachment replace the outdated attachment	32
attendee confirm the attendee list	5
backorder verify a documented backorder	41
before departure preserve the before-departure condition	59
booking status clarify booking status	59
budget authority confirm budget authority	24
calendar availability check calendar availability	5
calendar entry check the calendar entry	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

call log update the call log	15
call routing confirm call routing	14
callback request relay a callback request	14
caller identity verify caller identity	14
cancellation distinguish cancellation from comparison	60
capacity state the capacity limit	68
carry forward carry forward visitor signage	24
chair ask the chair to confirm	23
check-in complete the check-in	50
checked count report the checked count	41
commitment make a realistic commitment	69
competing request identify the competing request	68
conditional comparison give a conditional comparison	60
consensus verify consensus	24
contact details verify contact details	14
Coordinated Universal Time identify Coordinated Universal Time	6
correction notice send a correction notice	33
coverage confirm coverage	69
current guide link to the current guide	32
date-specific use a date-specific conversion	5
daylight saving time check daylight saving time	5
deadline clarify the deadline	68
decision log update the decision log	24
decision readback prepare a decision readback	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

deduction explain the deduction	59
deferred item retain the deferred item	24
delegation avoid unsupported delegation	69
deliverable define the deliverable	23
delivery note compare the delivery note	41
delivery reconciliation complete delivery reconciliation	42
delivery reference capture the delivery reference	14
department identify the correct department	15
departure confirm departure details	60
dispatch record check the dispatch record	42
displaced task identify the displaced task	69
distribution list check the distribution list	33
document link share the current document link	33
document owner contact the document owner	32
document version check the document version	32
due date record the due date	23
duration request the meeting duration	6
earliest finish calculate the earliest finish	69
editing permission distinguish editing permission	32
equivalent time read back the equivalent time	5
escort confirm the escort arrangement	51
existing obligation preserve existing obligations	69
extension confirm the extension	14
facilities identify the facilities host	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

facilities team contact the facilities team	14
fare state the fare	59
fare condition explain the fare condition	60
finance team distinguish the finance team	14
free slot identify a free slot	6
fulfillment distinguish partial fulfillment	42
full refund distinguish a full refund	60
handoff note prepare an accurate handoff note	15
handover coverage verify handover coverage	69
host contact the host	50
host availability check host availability	51
host notification send the host notification	50
identity match verify the identity match	51
invitation send the invitation	5
itinerary check the itinerary	60
local time confirm local time	5
location field complete the location field	6
meeting request clarify the meeting request	5
message readback give a message readback	15
message slip complete the message slip	14
minutes correct the minutes	24
misdirected call prevent a misdirected call	15
motion distinguish a motion from discussion	24
net refund calculate the net refund	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

next meeting	carry the item to the next meeting	24
nonrefundable	identify a nonrefundable fare	59
noon	specify noon	5
offset	verify the relevant offset	6
open item	preserve an open item	24
order reference	include the order reference	42
ordered quantity	verify the ordered quantity	41
organizer	identify the organizer	5
outstanding quantity	confirm the outstanding quantity	41
overcommitment	avoid overcommitment	69
packing list	compare the packing list	42
partial receipt	record a partial receipt	42
payment approval	keep payment approval separate	42
permission scope	preserve permission scope	32
preferred contact route	confirm the preferred contact route	14
price difference	state the price difference	59
priority decision	request a priority decision	68
priority item	identify the priority item	23
procurement	distinguish procurement stages	24
purchase approval	distinguish purchase approval	23
purchase order	quote the purchase order	41
purchasing approval	obtain purchasing approval	59
purpose of call	clarify the purpose of call	14
quantity discrepancy	report a quantity discrepancy	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

quotation obtain two quotations	23
quote gathering assign quote gathering	23
quoted terms preserve the quoted terms	59
rail quote compare rail quotes	59
read-only request read-only access	33
receipt record preserve the receipt record	42
reception wait at reception	50
reception floor verify the reception floor	33
reception wait explain the reception wait	51
recipient identify the affected recipient	32
recipient availability check recipient availability	15
recipient confirmation obtain recipient confirmation	15
recurrence confirm recurrence separately	6
reference correction record a reference correction	15
refund amount calculate the refund amount	59
refund eligibility check refund eligibility	60
refundable qualify refundable	59
replacement message issue a replacement message	33
reprioritization request reprioritization	69
requested deadline preserve the requested deadline	14
reservation verify a reservation	60
response commitment distinguish a response commitment	15
restricted area identify a restricted area	51
revised deadline obtain a revised deadline	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

revision control maintain revision control	33
room pack assemble the room pack	68
sales distinguish the sales colleague	50
schedule impact explain the schedule impact	69
schedule readback give a schedule readback	6
scheduled time confirm the scheduled time	50
scheduling conflict resolve a scheduling conflict	6
second package verify a second package	41
sequence agree the task sequence	68
shared folder locate the shared folder	32
shipment plan request the shipment plan	41
short delivery query a short delivery	41
source location identify the source location	33
split shipment confirm a split shipment	41
spreadsheet check perform the spreadsheet check	68
superseded mark the guide as superseded	32
supplier comparison prepare a supplier comparison	24
supplier query raise a supplier query	42
supplier response request a supplier response	42
surname confirm the surname	50
task duration specify task duration	68
tentative hold distinguish a tentative hold	6
ticket issuance distinguish ticket issuance	60
time display compare the time displays	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

time reference	clarify the time reference	5
time remaining	state the time remaining	23
time window	define the available time window	68
time zone	identify the time zone	5
trade-off	explain the trade-off	68
transfer	distinguish a transfer from a callback	15
travel authorization	distinguish travel authorization	60
unaccompanied access	distinguish unaccompanied access	51
unconfirmed meeting	identify the unconfirmed meeting	60
unit count	confirm the unit count	42
unrestricted link	avoid an unrestricted link	33
unverified explanation	avoid an unverified explanation	42
upfront cost	compare upfront costs	59
urgency	explain the urgency	15
version history	consult version history	33
viewing access	request viewing access	32
visitor badge	follow the visitor-badge procedure	51
visitor handoff	coordinate the visitor handoff	51
visitor list	prepare the visitor list	68
visitor log	update the visitor log	51
visitor reference	check the visitor reference	50
voicemail	identify the voicemail option	15
waiting area	explain the waiting area	50
workload	explain the workload	68

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Secretaries and Administrative Assistants.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for scheduling, documents, calls, records, and administrative coordination. The teaching cases are original and fictional. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Google Calendar Help. Use Google Calendar in Different Time Zones.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for distinguishing a meeting instant from local clock displays. The fictional case supplies its own date-specific equivalence. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Microsoft Support. Sharing Files, Folders, and List Items.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology for document links, viewing access, and permissions. The book does not instruct learners to change workplace access rights. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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